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DVD 1. ORIGINAL EFFORTLESS ENGLISH

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Effortless English

How To Use The Lessons

Welcome To Effortless English.

You now have a link to the download page. **Save the email and link. Do not lose it.** It is the only way you can download each lesson set.

Each lesson Set has at least 4 different lessons. All lessons in a Set have the same name, for example “Secret Love”. These lessons go together. Every day, you will listen to all the lessons in ONE lesson SET (all the lessons with the same name). You will listen to the lessons in only one set. You will listen to only one set for a week or more.

This is very important. You will only improve quickly if you follow this method-- one lesson set everyday-- the same lesson set every day for a week (or more).

Some sets have more than 4 lessons.

What kind of lessons are in each set, and how should you use them?

*A **Text Article** (Adobe .pdf file)
Read the article and review the wordlist if there is one. Do not “study” it. Don’t try to memorize it. Just read it a couple of times each day and review new words (in a relaxed way). Use a dictionary to translate difficult words, if necessary.

***Vocabulary Lesson** (MP3)
Just listen. Don’t try to memorize the words. Just listen to this lesson 1-3 times each day for at least a week.

***Mini-Story Lessons**(MP3)
This is the most powerful lesson. First time, just listen. Then, listen and pause after each question. Answer each question loudly in English, then play again. Continue to pause and answer after each question. Don’t worry if you don’t understand everything. Don’t worry about mistakes.

In the Mini-Story, I will do only three things:
1. I will make a statement. After a statement, just say, “Ahhhh” or “Ohhhh”.
2. I will ask a question that you know the answer to. Just answer the question. You don’t need to answer with a sentence. You can answer with only one or two words.
3. I will ask a question that you don’t know the answer to. Guess. Yell a guess immediately. Again, you can guess with just one (or a few) words. Complete sentences are not necessary.

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When you answer a question, don't worry about exact answers. Saying a correct and exact answer is not important. The most important thing is speed. Try to answer very quickly (remember, **one word is fine)**. Speed is your goal. You want short fast answers, not long answers! In the beginning, this may be difficult. That's OK. Use your pause button.

Eventually try to answer instantly, without using your pause button (this may take two weeks or even more).

Listen to this lesson many times every day for at least a week. The Mini-Story is the MOST IMPORTANT LESSON in the Effortless English system. LIsten to these lessons the most.

*__Audio Article__ (MP3)
Just listen. Relax and enjoy it. Listen to it several times each day for at least a week. Your goal is to understand 100% instantly and automatically.

Some sets also have:

*__Point of View Mini-Stories__
These are a way to improve grammar fluency, without studying. Just listen carefully. Relax. Do not think about grammar rules.

*__Commentaries__
These are extra talks about the topic. They might seem very difficult.

If they seem too difficult, skip them. The Commentary lessons are the LEAST IMPORTANT lessons in the Effortless English system. You can skip them if they feel too difficult.

However, if you understand 75% or more... listen. You probably won't understand everything-- its normal. Just relax and listen. Focus on the general ideas and information, not the language. Try to understand the main ideas. Listen to this lesson a couple of times each day for at least a week.

Suggested Lesson Order (Every Day Using The Same Set):
1. First, read the Text article. Read and review it, do not "study" it. Don't try to memorize it.
2. Listen to the Vocabulary Lesson a few times
3. Listen to the Mini-Story Lesson several times
4. Listen to the Point of View Mini-Story, if there is one, a few times.
5. Listen to the Audio many times
6. Listen to the Commentary once (if there is one, and if you can understand it).

Learning Schedule
Effortless English is a deep learning system. You will learn each lesson very well. You will relax, go slowly and learn to speak English easily and automatically.

The best study schedule is as follows:

*Study one lesson set for a week or more. That's right, only one set for at least a week. If you get

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bored, make a game with the Mini-Story lessons-- try to answer each question faster and faster.

*Everyday, listen to all of the lessons in the lesson set. Try to listen to each lesson (in the set) at least two times every day. Listen to each lesson in the set every day-- for at least a week. You should, therefore, **repeat** every lesson at least 20 times. 30 or more times for each lesson is best. Remember, the Mini-Stories and POV-Stories are most important.

*Listen at least one hour every day. **Two hours every day is best**. Its OK to divide your time during the day. For example, you might listen 30 minutes in the morning, 30 minutes going to work, 30 minutes during lunch, 30 minutes going home, and 30 minutes before going to sleep. In fact, this is an excellent way to learn.

*Relax :) Do not think about grammar rules. **Just listen** to the lessons and enjoy them. There is no pressure. You only need to listen and answer the questions (use the pause button).. If you have trouble, its OK. Just **relax**, go back to the beginning, and listen more. **Listening** is the most important activity.

*Start with the level "1." lessons. These are the slowest, shortest, and easiest lessons. Then move to the lesson sets that begin with "2.". These are faster. Finally, listen to the sets that begin with "3." These can be difficult, depending on your level.

Even if the lessons seem easy, listen to only one set for a full week. You might know the words very well, but you need them to **go deep** into your brain. You need a lot of repetition and a lot of answering questions. If the lessons seem easy, try to answer the questions very quickly-- make it a game.

If even the "1." level lessons seem difficult-- just **relax**. You can listen to one lesson set for 4 weeks, or 10 weeks if necessary. Don't worry about doing a lot of lesson sets. This is not important. Relax and focus on understanding. Choose one lesson set at level "1.". Listen to all the lessons in it everyday until you understand them 100% of the Audio lesson. Go slow. You will improve a lot, even if you listen to only one lesson set for 10 weeks!

The Effortless English Forum

As a user of the Effortless English System, you can join our Forum. The Forum is a place to meet other members. This is a new bonus for users of The Effortless English System.
Go to the Forum at: http://forum.effortlessenglish.org/

Use the Forum to meet other English speakers from all over the world. Schedule Skype discussions with other members. Share opinions, suggestions, and information.

When you try to add a comment, you will be asked to login.
Click "Not Registered? Sign Up Now!" and create an account.

Later, you will login with the username and password you created.

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The Effortless English Wiki

As a user of the Effortless English System, you can also join our Wiki for free. What's a wiki? A wiki is a group website. Each member can add pages and edit them.

You can, for example, create your own page to introduce yourself to other Effortless English members. You can also add a link to your personal blog or webpage.

And the wiki has a chat room where you can talk to other members who are online when you are. To get started with your own page, go to:

http://effortlessenglish.pbwiki.com/
The password is: **wuwei**

My Blog

Do you want to learn more about Effortless English? Do you have a comment or suggestion for me? Read my blog at:
http://www.EffortlessEnglishClub.blogspot.com

You will learn more about the Lessons. You'll learn more about me. You'll hear about new Lesson Albums that are coming. And you'll learn more about learning English fast and easily.

You can also leave a comment for me!

Make Extra Money and Help Others Improve Their English

Because you are a member, you will also help other people improve their English. When you do you also make extra money for yourself. How?

Become an Effortless English Affiliate. You get a 50% commission for every person who gets The Effortless English Club Lessons from your website or blog. That's almost 50 USD. If 100 people join, you get **$5000**.

At Effortless English, you not only learn English, you are also a **partner**. You will help other people find a better way to learn English. You will help other people speak English easily and fast. And you will make extra money for yourself.

To become a partner, help others and make extra money, **read the "Affiliate Partner Guide"**.
Good luck and enjoy the Effortless English System,

A.J. Hoge
Director
Effortless English, Inc.
www.EffortlessEnglishClub.com

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HOW TO USE TRANSCRIPTS

These are text transcripts for all the Level 1 & 2 Mini-Stories

What about level 3? Well, Level 3 is the advanced level. I want you to focus ONLY on listening at that level. Once you reach level 3, you need to focus all of your attention on listening.

Sometimes you won't understand everything-- that is OK. Just keep listening-- listen to each Mini-Story many times. Relax. Enjoy. You will improve.

How To Use These Text Transcripts (for level 1& 2 Mini-Stories):

1. First, try to only listen
Don't use these text transcripts first. Try to listen to the mini-stories without the text. If you understand them, you don't need the text-- just continue to listen.

2. Use these text transcripts only when you don't undertand something
If you don't understand part of a Mini-Story, read the text. This will help you identify vocabulary you might not understand from just listening. Use a dictionary, if necessary, to find unknown words.

3. Read and Listen at the same time, a few times
Once you know all of the words and phrases in a Mini-Story, you can listen and read at the same time. Do this a few times only

4. Just Listen again
As soon as possible, focus on just listening-- without reading. These text transcripts are only a supplement. DO NOT FOCUS ON READING-- FOCUS ON LISTENING! Most of your time should be spent only listening to the Mini-Stories (and answering the questions). These text transcripts can help you, but don't use them too much :)

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7 RULE TO LEARN ENGLISH

RULE 1: Study Phrases, Not Individual Words

Never study a single, individual word. Never.
When you find a new word, always write down The Phrase it is in. Always. When you review, always review all of the phrase,.. not the word.
Collect phrases.
Your speaking and grammar will improve 4-5 times faster. Always write the complete phrase.
Never again study a single word. Never write a single word in your notebook,
Learn Phrases Only.

Quy tắc 1: Học theo từng cụm, không phải từ đơn lẻ
Không bao giờ học một từ đơn lẻ.
Khi bạn gặp một từ mới, luôn viết trọn câu, cụm chứa từ đó. Khi bạn ôn lại nó luôn ôn cả cụm, không phải một từ.
Thu thập các cụm liên quan đến từ đó.
Kỹ năng nói và viết của bạn sẽ tiến bộ nhanh hơn 4-5 lần. Luôn viết ra một cụm hoàn chỉnh.
Không học lại chỉ một từ, không viết lại chỉ một từ ra giấy. Chỉ học theo cụm.

RULE 2: Don’t Study Grammar

Stop studying grammar.
Right now. Stop. Put away your grammar books and textbooks.
Grammar rules teach you to think about English, you want to speak automatically– without thinking!
With Effortless English, you learn English without grammar study. Your speaking improves quickly. You succeed. You speak English naturally.
So Rule 2 is: Don’t Study Grammar!

Quy tắc 2: Không học ngữ pháp.
Ngừng học ngữ pháp.
Ngay bây giờ, Gạt sang một bên sách ngữ pháp của bạn. Các luật ngữ pháp

How do you learn deeply? Easy– just repeat all lessons or listening many times. For example, if you have an audio book, listen to the first chapter 30 times before you go to the second chapter. You could listen to the first chapter 3 times each day, for 10 days.

Quy tắc 4: Học tiếng Anh chậm, sâu là cách tốt nhất.

Bí quyết để nói dể dàng là học từ và cụm sâu sắc.

Sẽ không đủ để biết một định nghĩa, sẽ không đủ để nhớ cho một bài kiểm tra.

Bạn phải đặt một từ thật sâu vào trong đầu.

Để nói tiếng Anh tốt bạn phải nhắc lại từng bài nhiều lần.

Bạn phải học tiếng Anh thật sâu.

Học càng sâu, nói càng dể dàng.

Học sâu bằng cách nào? Rất đơn giản – Nhắc lại hoặc nghe lại tất cả các bài nhiều lần.

Ví dụ ; Bạn có một audio, Hãy nghe chương đầu 30 lần trước khi chuyển sang chương tiếp theo. Bạn có thể nghe chương đầu 3 lần mỗi ngày và nghe trong 10 ngày.

RULE 5: Use Point Of View Mini-Stories

I call these stories “Point Of View Mini-Stories”. They are the most powerful way to learn and use English grammar automatically.

Use Point of View Stories for Automatic Grammar

You must learn grammar by listening to real English. The best way is to listen to the same story… told in different times (points of view): Past, Perfect, Present, Future.

How do you do this? Easy! Find a story or article in the present tense. Then ask your native speaker tutor to write it again in the Past, with Perfect tenses, and in the Future. Finally, ask him to read and record these stories for you.

Then you can listen to story with many different kinds of grammar. You don’t need to know the grammar rules. Just listen to the Point of View stories and you will improve grammar automatically!

You can also find Point of View lessons and use them to learn grammar automatically.

It is powerful. It is simple. It is successful. You will succeed. You will use correct grammar naturally and automatically.

This is the secret to English grammar.

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Quy tắc 5: Use Point Of View Mini-Stories*Tôi gọi các câu chuyện này là Point Of View Mini-Stories (chưa biết dịch sao cho đúng). Đó là cách hiệu quả nhất để học và dùng ngữ pháp tiếng Anh một cách tự nhiên..*
Dùng Point of View Stories cho ngữ pháp phản xạ tự nhiên.
Bạn phải học ngữ pháp thông qua nghe tiếng Anh chuẩn. Cách tốt nhất là nghe cùng một câu chuyện được kể trong nhiều lần, nhiều thời điểm khác nhau (points of view): quá khứ, hiện tại, tương lai. Làm sao làm vậy được? Dể thôi! Tìm một bài báo hay câu chuyện trong thì hiện tại sau đó nhờ người nói tiếng bản xứ viết lại nó ở quá khứ, với thì hoàn thành, và trong tương lai. Cuối cùng, nhờ người ấy đọc và ghi âm lại những câu chuyện ấy cho bạn.
Sau đó bạn có thể nghe lại câu chuyện này với nhiều dạng ngữ pháp khác nhau. Bạn không cần biết đến các quy luật ngữ pháp. Chỉ cần nghe Point of View stories và bạn sẽ tiến bộ một cách tự nhiên.
Bạn có thể tìm bài tập Point of View và dùng nó để học ngữ pháp một cách tự nhiên. Nó rất hiệu quả, đơn giản và bạn sẽ thành công. Bạn sẽ dùng đúng ngữ pháp một cách tự nhiên.
Đây là bí quyết để học ngữ pháp.

RULE 6: Only Use Real English Lessons & Materials

You learn real English if you want to understand native speakers and speak easily. Use real magazines, audio articles, TV shows, movies, radio talk shows, and audio books.
Learn Real English, Not Textbook English
Learn Real English, Not Textbook English
Quy tắc 6: Chỉ dùng những tài liệu và bài anh văn chuẩn
Bạn học anh văn chuẩn nếu bạn muốn hiểu được người bản sứ và nói một cách dể dàng.Dùng các bài báo , tạp chí, chương trình truyền hình, phim, đài và các audio chuẩn.
Học tiếng Anh chuẩn chứ không phải sách tiếng Anh.

RULE 7: Listen and Answer, not Listen and Repeat

Use Listen & Answer Mini-Story Lessons
In each Mini-Story Lesson, a speaker tells a short simple story. He also asks a lot of easy questions. Every time you hear a question, you pause and answer it.
You learn to answer questions quickly– without thinking. Your English becomes automatic.

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LEVEL 1

1.1.**Day of the Dead**

I arrive in Guatemala on The Day of the Dead, November 1st. I'm curious about this holiday, so I go to the **cemetery** to see what's happening. What I find is quite interesting.

The **atmosphere** is like a party. There are people everywhere. Families are sitting around the **graves** of their dead **ancestors**. They clean the graves and add fresh flowers. I walk through the cemetery and admire the beauty of all the colorful flowers.

There is also color in the sky, because many kids are flying **kites**. Some families are having a picnic next to the graves. They eat, drink, and chat together. People laugh and smile.

In the Unites States, cemeteries are always **somber**. We certainly never have festivals or parties next to graves. We don't laugh or play music or fly kites in cemeteries either.

I **find that** I prefer the Guatemalan **approach**. I like the way they remember and celebrate those who have **passed away**. I like that they acknowledge death, instead of denying it the way Americans do. I like that there is life, as well as death, in their cemeteries.

Guatemalans call it "The Day of the Dead", but it is also a day to appreciate life.

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Effortless English

1.2. **A Kiss**

huge: adj. very very big

Carlos buys a new car. It's a very expensive car. It's a **huge**, blue, fast car. While driving down the street, Carlos sees a girl on a bicycle. She has long blond hair and is beautiful.

What's up: a greeting, "hello"

He yells to her, "**What's up**?"

ignores: v. doesn't listen to

She **ignores** him.

How's it going: a greeting, "How are you?"

He yells, "**How's it going**?"

keeps: v. continues

She **keeps** going and ignores him.

That's it: idiom. "That is all", there is no more, that is everything

He yells, "Hey, why won't you talk to me? I want to go to dinner with you. I'll take you to an expensive restaurant."

The girl turns, gets off the bike, and looks at him. She says, "I don't want to go to dinner. But if you give me your car, I will give you a surprise."

Past Tense Verb Forms

buys: bought
is: was
driving: was driving
drive: drove
sees: saw
has: had
yells: yelled
ignores: ignored
keeps: kept
turns: turned
looks: looked
says: said
jumps: jumped
gives: gave
takes: took
kisses: kissed
drives: drove
stands: stood
gets on: got on
rides: rode

Carlos says, "OK!" He jumps out of the car. He gives her the keys and says, "Here are the keys."

The beautiful blond takes the keys and then kisses Carlos on the cheek. Then she jumps into the car and drives away.

Carlos stands on the sidewalk. Now he has no car and no girl. He says, "**That's it**, just a kiss on the cheek?"

He gets on her bike and rides home.

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A Kiss MS-A

Welcome to the mini story for A Kiss. In this lesson I will ask many questions. You must answer every question. Answer every question. Pause your computer or pause your iPod, answer the question, then play again. It's very important – very important. Answer every question.
Let's start A Kiss. Carlos bought a new car. Did Carlos buy a new car? Yes. Yes, of course. He bought a new car.

Did Carlos buy an old car? No. Carlos didn't buy an old car. Carlos bought a new car. Did Carlos buy an old car or a new car? A new car. Carlos bought a new car.

Who bought a new car? Carlos, right? Carlos bought a new car. What did Carlos buy? A new car. Carlos bought a new car. Was the car expensive or was the car cheap?

Ah. It was expensive. Carlos bought a very expensive car. Did Carlos buy an expensive bicycle? No, no. He didn't. He didn't buy an expensive bicycle.

What did he buy? He bought an expensive car. Was the car small? No, no. It wasn't small. He bought a huge car – very, very big car. How big was the car? It was huge.

It was huge. Was it a huge bicycle? No, no. It wasn't a huge bicycle. It was a huge car. Who bought the huge car? Carlos. Carlos bought the huge car.

What color was the car? Was it yellow? No. What color was the car? Blue. It was blue. It was a huge, blue, fast car.

While driving down the street Carlos saw a girl on a bicycle. What did he see while driving down the street? He saw a girl on a bicycle while driving down the street. While driving down the street, did Carlos see a dog? No. No, he didn't.

While driving down the street Carlos saw a girl. While driving down the street did Carlos see a girl in a car? No, no. She wasn't in a car – not in a car. While driving down the street Carlos saw a girl on a bicycle.

When did Carlos see a girl on a bicycle? While driving down the street, right? While driving down the street Carlos saw a girl on a bicycle. Who saw a girl on a bicycle while he was driving down the street? Carlos, right? Carlos saw a girl on a bicycle while he was driving down the street.

Where was Carlos driving? Driving down the street – down the street. Carlos was driving down the street. Where was the girl? On a bicycle, right? The girl was on a bicycle, so while driving down the street Carlos saw a girl on a bicycle.

She had long, blonde hair and was beautiful. What did she look like? Look like means was she ugly, was she beautiful, was her hair black, brown. Look like means how does she look – her hair, her face – so what did she look like? Well, she had long, blonde hair and she was beautiful.

What did she look like? She had long, blonde hair and she was beautiful. Did she look beautiful?

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Yes, yes. She looked beautiful. Did she look ugly or did she look beautiful? She looked beautiful. Who looked beautiful? Ah, the girl, right? The girl on the bicycle. The girl on the bicycle looked beautiful. Carlos yelled to her.

What did he yell? He yelled, “What’s up!” Who yelled, “What’s up!”? Carlos. Carlos yelled, “What’s up!” Did the girl yell, “What’s up!”? No. The girl didn’t yell, “What’s up!”

Carlos yelled, “What’s up!” Who did Carlos yell to? Ah, the girl. Carlos yelled to the girl. Did Carlos yell to a boy? No. He didn’t yell to a boy. Carlos yelled to a girl.

Which girl did Carlos yell to? Which girl did Carlos yell to? Ah, the girl on the bicycle, right? He yelled to the girl on a bicycle.

What did he yell to the girl on a bicycle? He yelled, “What’s up!” After he yelled, “What’s up!” did the girl ignore him? Yes. Yes, she did. She ignored him.

Who ignored Carlos? The girl. The girl on the bicycle. Did Carlos ignore her? No, no. Carlos didn’t ignore her. Carlos yelled to her. She ignored him.

Did she listen to Carlos? No, she didn’t listen to Carlos. She ignored him. Did she look at Carlos? No, she didn’t. She ignored him.

Carlos yelled again. “How’s it going?” What did he yell? “How’s it going?” Did he yell, “How’s it going?” to the girl or to his mother? Well, of course he yelled, “How’s it going?” to the girl.

Did he yell, “How’s it going?” or did he whisper, “How’s it going?” Whisper means talk very quietly; opposite of yell, so we have yell and whisper. I am whispering. Did Carlos whisper or did he yell, “How’s it going?” He yelled.

Carlos yelled, “How’s it going?” He didn’t whisper, “How’s it going?” He yelled, “How’s it going?” After he yelled, “How’s it going?” did the girl stop? No, she didn’t. The girl didn’t stop.
The girl kept going. Did the girl keep going? Yes. The girl kept going. Did she continue going? Yes. She continued, right? She kept going.

Who kept going? The girl. The girl kept going. He yelled again, “Hey! Why won’t you talk to me? I want to go to dinner with you. I’ll take you to an expensive restaurant.”

Where did he want to take her? To an expensive restaurant. He wanted to take her to an expensive restaurant. This is the end of mini story A. Listen to this many times and then go to mini story B.
[End of Audio]

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A Kiss MS-B

Hello. Welcome to mini story B. Let's continue.

Carlos asked the girl, "Why won't you talk to me?" Would the girl talk to him? In the past, before, would she talk to him? No, no. She wouldn't – she would not – talk to him.

Who would not talk to Carlos? The girl, right? The beautiful girl. The beautiful girl wouldn't talk to Carlos. Would the beautiful girl talk to Carlos? No. No, she wouldn't. She wouldn't talk to Carlos. The beautiful girl wouldn't talk to Carlos. Carlos wanted to go to dinner with her and he yelled, "I'll take you to an expensive restaurant." What kind of restaurant did Carlos want to take the girl to? What kind? An expensive restaurant. He wanted to take her to an expensive restaurant.

He said – this is future now – "I'll take you – I will, I'll, I'll – I'll take you to an expensive restaurant." Did he want to take her to a cheap restaurant? No, not to a cheap restaurant. He wanted to take her to an expensive restaurant.

Finally the girl turned. She got off her bike and she looked at him. She said, "I don't want to go to dinner." Did she want to go to dinner? No. What did she want? Ah, she wanted his car – his car. She wanted his car. Who wanted Carlos's car? The girl. The beautiful girl wanted Carlos's car. Did she want Carlos's bicycle? No, no. She wanted his car.

She wanted Carlos's car. Whose car did she want? She wanted Carlos's car. Did she want Carlos's car or Carlos's truck? She wanted Carlos's car.

She said, "If you give me your car I will give you a surprise." Ah, what did she say? She said, "If you give me your car I will give you a surprise." What did Carlos say? He said, "Okay!"

Who said, "Okay"? Carlos. Who did Carlos talk to – talk to? The beautiful girl. Carlos said, "Okay," to the beautiful girl. Carlos talked to the beautiful girl. He said, "Okay."

After he said, "Okay," what did he do? He jumped out of his car. Whose car did he jump out of? His car, right? His own car. He jumped out of his car and said, "Okay!"

Then he gave her the keys and said, "Here are they keys." What did he give her? The keys, right? The keys to his car. Who gave the keys to the beautiful girl? Carlos. Carlos gave the keys to the beautiful girl.

Who did Carlos give his keys to? To the beautiful girl. He gave his keys to the beautiful girl. What did he give to her? His keys.

Did he give his house keys to the girl? No, not his house keys. Did he give his car keys to the girl? Yes, that's right. He gave his car keys to the girl.

Which keys did he give to the girl? Car keys, right? He gave the car keys to the girl – not his house keys, not other keys. He gave only the car keys. Which keys did he give? That's right. The car keys.

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He said, “Here are the keys.” The beautiful blonde took the keys. What did she take? The keys. That’s right. She took the keys.

Who took the keys? The beautiful blonde girl. Who took the keys? The beautiful blonde girl. What kind of girl was she? She was a beautiful blonde girl.

What kind of keys did she take? Ah, car keys, right? She took car keys. Who took the car keys? The beautiful girl. She took the car keys and then she kissed Carlos on the cheek.

Who did she kiss on the cheek? Carlos. She kissed Carlos on the cheek. Where did she kiss Carlos? On the cheek. She kissed Carlos on the cheek.

Did she kiss Carlos on the nose? No, she didn’t kiss Carlos on the nose. She kissed Carlos on the cheek. Who kissed Carlos on the cheek? The beautiful girl. The beautiful girl kissed Carlos on the cheek.

What did she do? She kissed Carlos. When did she kiss Carlos on the cheek? When did she kiss Carlos on the cheek? After she took the keys.

After she took the keys she kissed Carlos on the cheek. Did she kiss Carlos before she took they keys? No. She didn’t kiss Carlos before she took the keys. She kissed Carlos after she took the keys. After she took the keys and after she kissed Carlos, what did she do? Jumped in the car. After she kissed Carlos she jumped in the car. Did she jump onto her bicycle? No. She didn’t jump onto her bicycle. She jumped into the car. Did she jump into the car or did she jump onto her bicycle? She jumped into the car.

Whose car did she jump into? Carlos’ – Carlos’. That ’s – Carlos’s – means it’s his car. It’s possessive. His car. Whose car is it? It’s Carlos’, so she jumped into Carlos’ car.

Did she jump into AJ’s car or Carlos’ car? She jumped into Carlos’ car. What did she do? She jumped into Carlos’ car and then she drove away. Did she walk away? No, no. She didn’t walk away.

Did she run away? No. She didn’t run away. She drove away. Who drove away? The beautiful girl.

When did she drive away? She drove away after she jumped into the car – after she jumped into the car. Carlos stood on the sidewalk. He had no car and he had no girl. He said, “That’s it? Just a kiss on the cheek?”

Did Carlos get more? No, no, no. He said, “That’s it,” nothing more. Who said, “That’s it?” Carlos. He said, “That’s it? Just a kiss on the cheek?” Nothing more for Carlos.

He stood on the sidewalk. Did he sit on the sidewalk? No, he didn’t sit on the sidewalk. He stood on the sidewalk. Where did Carlos stand? Carlos stood on the sidewalk.

Did he stand on the street or did he stand on the sidewalk? Well, he stood on the sidewalk. Carlos

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stood on the sidewalk. Was he happy when he stood on the sidewalk? No, no. He wasn't happy. He had no car and no girl. He wasn't happy when he stood on the sidewalk. What did he say? He said, "That's it? Just a kiss on the cheek?" He got on her bike and rode home.

Did he ride to work? No, no. He didn't ride to work. He rode home. Did he ride to his friend's house? No, he didn't ride to his friend's house. He rode home.

Where did he ride? Well, he rode home. Who rode home? Carlos. Carlos rode home. On what did he ride home? On what did he ride home? On her bike, right? He rode home on her bike. What did he ride home on? On her bike. He rode home on her bike. What did he ride home on? He rode home on her bike.

Did he ride home in a car or did he ride home on a bike? On a bike. He rode home on a bike. Okay. That's it for mini story B.

[End of Audio]

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Effortless English

1.3. **Bubba's Food**

Sara Smith, who lives in San Francisco, went shopping for cat food.

Sara is 30, and lives at 3037 Market St. She **has lived** there since 1990. Sara is married. She is married to a man named John. She **has been** married for 7 years.

They have two children, and one very big cat. Their son Bob is five years old and their daughter Nancy is three. Their cat, Bubba, is 2 years old. Bubba is **huge**. He weighs 258 pounds (117 kilos)!

At 9am, Sara **got into** her car and **drove** to the pet store. She **bought** 68 bags of cat food for $10 each plus tax. The regular price was $15, so she **got a good deal.** The total was $680. She paid by credit card.

On her way home, Sara stopped at a convenience store to buy milk. Bubba loves milk. The milk was $3.00 for one gallon, and Sara bought 30 gallons. She paid $100 and got $10 **back in change**.

Sara **got home** at 11 a.m. Bubba was waiting at the door. He was very hungry.

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1.4. **Changed**

NO AFFECTION ANYMORE

DEAR ABBY:

My husband of 39 years **no longer hugs** me or shows me any **affection**. I have **seen him through** cancer and diabetes. We have four grown children, and we have been **seeing** a **therapist** for a year and a half. He is kind, generous and friendly, but there are no **compliments** or any of the **flirtatious banter** we used to enjoy.

He **swears** he's not **having an affair**, and he doesn't know why he has changed. Perhaps you do?

-- GRACE IN PHOENIX

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Changed MS-A

Hello. Welcome to mini story A. Mini story A for Changed. In this mini story I will ask questions you know. Okay. Questions about the letter that you know. Let's start.

There is a woman. Where does she live? Where did she live? Let's practice past. Where did this woman live? Well she lived in Phoenix. Alright. She lived in Phoenix. Did she live in Phoenix, Texas? No, Phoenix isn't in Texas. Did she live in Phoenix, Arizona? Yes she did. She lived in Phoenix, Arizona.

Who lived in Phoenix, Arizona? Ah, Grace. Alright. Her name is Grace. Grace lived in Phoenix, Arizona. Did she live in Phoenix, Arizona or Tucson, Arizona? Well, she lived in Phoenix, Arizona. Grace lived in Phoenix, Arizona.

Did Grace have a problem? Did Grace have a problem? Yes, she had a problem. Did she have a problem with her children? No, no. She didn't have a problem with her children. Did she have a problem with her mom? No. She didn't have a problem with her mom. Did she have a problem with her husband? Yes, she had a problem with her husband.

What problem did she have with her husband? Ahh, no affection. Alright. He didn't show her any affection. Did he show her affection? No, he didn't. He didn't show her any affection. Did he show her a little affection? No, he didn't. He didn't show her any affection. Did he show her a lot of affection? No, no, none, zero. Her didn't show her any affection. Who didn't show her any affection? Ah, her husband, yeah. Her husband didn't show her any affection. Did she want her husband to show her affection? Of course, of course she did. Yes. Definitely, yes. She wanted her husband to show her affection.

Was she happy about her husband? No, she wasn't happy. Was she sad about her husband? Yeah, yeah. She was sad about her husband. Why was she sad about her husband? Ahh, because he didn't show her any affection. She was sad because he didn't show her any affection.

She saw him through cancer and diabetes. Did she see him through cancer? Yes, she saw him through cancer. Did she see him through a heart attack? No, no, no. Not a heart attack. She didn't see him through a heart attack. She saw him through cancer and diabetes. Did he have cancer and diabetes in the past? Yes, yes he did. In the past he had cancer and diabetes. Did she see him through cancer and diabetes? Yes, yes she did.

Did she stay with him when he was sick? That's right. Yes, she did. She stayed with him when he was sick. Did she leave him when he was sick? Nooo, she didn't leave him when he was sick. She stayed with him when he was sick. When he was sick did she stay or did she leave? Ahh, she stayed. Right. She's a great wife. She stayed with him when he was sick.

How long have they been married? Hmm, ahh, 39 years. Right. She said, "39 years." They have been married 39 years. Have they been married 37 years? Nooo, they haven't been married 37 years. Have they been married 37 years or have they been married 39 years? That's right 39. They have been married 39 years. Have they been married 39 years? Yes, exactly. They have been married 39 years.

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When did they get married? Hmm. When did they get married? They got married 39 years ago. Did they get married 38 years ago? Noo, no, no, no not 38. They got married 39 years ago. They got married 39 years ago. Are they still married now? Yes, they are still married. They are married now. Okay.

Who are they seeing? Hmm. They are seeing a therapist. Are they seeing a doctor? No, they're not seeing a doctor. Are they seeing a therapist? Yes, they are seeing a therapist. Are they meeting with a therapist or are they meeting with a doctor? Well, they are meeting with a therapist. Right. They are seeing a therapist. They are meeting with a therapist.

How long have they been meeting with a therapist? Ahh, for a year and a half. Who have they been seeing for a year and a half? They have been seeing a therapist for a year and a half. Have they been meeting with a doctor for a year and a half? Nope, not a doctor. Have they been meeting with a therapist for a year and a half? Yes. Who has been meeting with a therapist for a year and a half? Well Grace and her husband. The husband and wife have been meeting with a therapist for a year and a half.

Does the husband – did the husband compliment Grace? No, he didn't compliment her anymore. Who didn't compliment Grace anymore? Well, her husband. Right. Her husband didn't compliment her anymore. Did she want her husband to compliment her? Yes, of course, definitely. She wanted her husband to compliment her, but he didn't compliment her anymore.

Was Grace happy or was Grace sad because her husband didn't compliment her anymore? Oooh, yeah, sad of course. She was sad. She was sad because her husband didn't compliment her anymore.

Was her husband having an affair? Ummm. No, no. He wasn't having an affair. Well, he said, "He wasn't having an affair." Who wasn't having an affair? Umm. Grace's husband. Grace's husband wasn't having an affair. Did he swear that he wasn't having an affair? Yes, that's right. He swore, swore, past tense, he swore he wasn't having an affair. Did he promise he wasn't having an affair? Yes, he promised he wasn't having an affair. What did he promise? Um. He promised he wasn't having an affair. Who did he promise? Oooh. He promised Grace. Right. He promised Grace that he wasn't having an affair.

Okay, that is all of mini story A. Listen to it many, many times. Listen to it every day. Do this for two weeks or more. And of course answer every question. Okay. Bye, bye.

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Changed MS-B

Okay. Welcome to mini story B for Changed. In this mini story I will ask questions you know and I will also ask questions you don't know. If you don't know the answer you must guess. You must guess. Okay. Let's start.

What was the woman's name? Ah, that's easy. Her name was Grace. Right. Grace. The woman's name was Grace. What was her husband's name? Was it Buford or Tom? Her husband's name was Buford. Of course, her husband's name was Buford. What was her name? Hmm. Her name was Grace. And what was his name? His name was Buford.

Okay, Buford and Grace had been married 39 years. But they had a problem. What was their problem? Ahh, no affection. Right. No more affection. Their problem was that there was no affection from Buford. Who didn't show affection? Ah, Buford. Buford didn't show affection. What didn't Buford do? Hmm. Buford didn't show affection. When didn't Buford show affection? Well, never. Never. Did he show affection in the morning? Noo, he didn't show affection in the morning. Did he show affection at night? No, he didn't show affection at night. Did he show affection in the afternoon? No, he didn't. Buford never showed affection to Grace.

Where did they live? Well, they lived in Phoenix, Arizona. Did he show affection to Grace in Phoenix? Noo, he didn't. Did he show affection to Grace in San Francisco? Nope. No, not in San Francisco. He never showed affection to Grace.

How many children did they have? They had four children. Did they have two children? No, they had four children.

Were they seeing a therapist? Yes, they were seeing a therapist. What was the therapist's name? The therapist's name was Dr. Phil. Was the therapist's name Dr. Phil? Yes, the therapist's name was Dr. Phil. Who was the therapist? The therapist was Dr. Phil.

What did the therapist tell Buford and Grace? Ahhh, Dr. Phil told Buford and Grace to go to a nude beach. Hmm. Nude N U D E, nude means no clothes. No clothes. Not wearing clothes. No shirts. No pants. Nothing. Nude. Nude, no clothes. And a beach B E A C H. Right. Beach has sand and sun and water. Right. Next to the ocean. Next to the ocean. So a nude beach is a beach where people do not wear clothes. No clothes. Ahh. So Dr. Phil told them to go to a nude beach. Where did Dr. Phil tell them to go? He told them to go to a nude beach. Who did Dr. Phil tell to go to a nude beach? Ahhh, Grace and Buford. He told Grace and Buford to go to a nude beach.

When did he want them to go? Ahh. He wanted them to go on New Year's Day. New Year's Day. Okay. It's January 1st. January number 1. Right. January 1st. He wanted them to go to a nude beach on January 1st. Which nude beach did he want them to go to? Hmm. Did he want them to go to a Los Angeles nude beach or to an Alaska nude beach? Of course, Alaska. Alaska. You know, very cold. Is Alaska hot or is Alaska cold? Alaska is very cold. Alright, next to Canada. It's very cold. Did he want them to go to a nude beach in Alaska? Yes he did. Dr. Phil wanted them to go to a nude beach in Alaska. Hmm. When did Dr. Phil want them to go to a nude beach in Alaska? Ahhh, New Year's Day, January 1st. Dr. Phil wanted them to go to a nude beach in Alaska on January 1st.

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Who did Dr. Phil want to go to Alaska, to a nude beach on January 1st? Ahhh, Buford and Grace. He wanted Buford and Grace to go to a nude beach in Alaska on January 1st. Do they wear clothes at a nude beach? No, no, no one wears clothes at a nude beach or on a nude beach. Do people wear shirts on a nude beach? Nooo, no, no, no. Do people wear pants on a nude beach? Noooo. Do people wear socks on a nude beach? S O X sox. Nooooooo. Do people wear underwear, underwear, do people wear underwear on a nude beach? Noooo. People do not wear underwear on a nude beach. Are people naked N A K E D? Are people naked on a nude beach? Yes, yes they are. They are naked. They have no clothes.

Why did Dr. Phil want them to go to a nude beach in Alaska on January 1st? Why? Obviously because it's very, very cold. Because it's very cold. Why does, why did, I'm sorry. Why did Dr. Phil want them to be cold? Why did Dr. Phil want them to be cold on a nude beach? Ahhh, obviously so they would hug each other. Ahhhh, very obvious, obviously. So they would hug each other. If they were cold then they would hug each other. Right. If they are cold then they will hug each other. Dr. Phil wanted them to go to a nude beach in Alaska on January 1st because they would be cold and then they would hug each other. Ahhhhhhh, interesting.

Did Dr. Phil want them to hug each other? Yes, yes he did. Did Dr. Phil want them to hug each other in Alaska? Yes, he did. Where did Dr. Phil want them to hug? In Alaska. He wanted them to hug each other in Alaska. Who did he want to hug each other in Alaska on January 1st? Who? Ah. Buford and Grace. Dr. Phil wanted Buford and Grace to hug each other on a nude beach in Alaska on January 1st.

Did this help Buford and Grace? Yeess, it did. It helped Buford and Grace. Did it solve their problem? Solve S O L V E, solve. Did is solve their problem? Yeess, yes, they hugged each other on the nude beach in Alaska on January 1st. Yeeaah. They hugged each other.

Are they happy now? Now. Right. Are they happy now? Yeess, now they are happy. Now Buford and Grace are happy again.

Okay, that's all. Listen to this mini story several times, many, many times. Answer all the questions. Okay. See ya next time. Bye, bye.

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Effortless English

1.5. **Drag**

HIGH PRICE OF MOM'S HELP IS **DRAG** ON FAMILY BUSINESS

DEAR ABBY:

Twenty years ago, my sister and I bought a business from our mother. We all love and respect one another and get along well. We will be finished **paying off** the business in two years.

Our problem: Mom, who is now 77, still **draws a salary** from us **above and beyond** the payment for the business. Her **workload** has **lessened** greatly, as it should. She could do all of her work in one day and lessen the **burden** of her salary. However, she says she'd "go crazy" if she **retired**. We don't want that. She could still come in as often as she wants and do her personal paperwork, banking, letter-writing, reading, etc. These are all things she does at "work" -- **on the clock**.

If we try to discuss this, Mom gets hurt and says, "Just let me know when I'm not worth the money." We don't want to do that. We would hope she would see the fairness of this and suggest it herself.

Business **expenses** are **going through the roof**, and there are **updates** we should make, but we can't do it as long as we are paying Mom at the level we are, **on top of** the money for the **buy-out**.

-- DAUGHTERS DEAREST

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Effortless English

1.6. **Intimacy**

DEAR ABBY:

My husband, "James," and I have been married only three years. We are both **in our 20s**. Everything is really great between us -- except our sex life. **As far as he is concerned** that's fine, too, but I am not **satisfied**. It may seem **odd** to hear the female wants to have sex more **frequently** than a young and healthy **male**, but that's **the case** in our relationship.

Abby, I **work with the public** and I get frequent **remarks** about what a beautiful woman I am. This makes it hard for me to believe that I don't attract him at all. I have **expressed** many times that I wish we were more **intimate**. I have even expressed it to him in more than one letter, hoping **to reach him**.

I am **at a total loss** as to how to make him realize how important this is to me. Is there something wrong with my body? I just don't know who **to turn to** for advice on this subject. Please help me.

-- **SHORT ON** INTIMACY IN OHIO

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Intimacy MS-A

Hello, welcome to mini-story A for Intimacy. In mini-story A, I will ask questions about the article, about the letter. I will only ask questions you know. In mini-story A, you will know the answers. In mini-story B, you will need to guess; but this mini-story, no guessing. Okay, let's go. Are you ready?

The woman has a husband. Who was her husband? What was his name? Who was her husband? (Gasp) Well, look at the text. His name was James. Right? James. What was his name? His name was James.

Was James her husband? Yes, James was her husband. Was she the woman? Was she in her 30s? Was she in her 30s? Noooooo, no, she wasn't in her 30s. She was in her 20s.

Was James in his 20s? Yes, yes, James was in his 20s. The woman was in her 20s. Were they both in their 20s? Yes, they were both in their 20s. How old were they? Well, they were in their 20s. Right? How old were they? They were in their 20s.

Did the woman have a problem? Yes, yes, she had a problem. Did she have a problem with money? No, she didn't have a problem with money. Did she have a problem with James? Yeahhhhhh, she had a problem with James.

What kind of problem did she have with James? Well, she had a sex problem, right? She had a problem with their sex life. A sex problem. Did she have a sex problem with Bill? No, no, not Bill. Did she have a sex problem with Fred? No, no, she didn't have a sex problem with Fred.

Who did she have a sex problem with? With James. She a sex problem with James. Did James think they had a problem? Noooooo, no, he didn't. James thought everything was fine. Right? As far as he was concerned, there was no problem.

Did she think everything was fine? No, no, the woman thought there was a problem. Did James think there was a problem? No, James didn't think there was a problem. What did James think? Well, James thought everything was fine.

Was James satisfied? Was he happy? Yeah, James was satisfied. James was happy. Was the woman satisfied? Noooooo, the woman was not satisfied.

Did she think this problem was strange? Yes, yes, she thought the problem was strange. She thought the problem was odd. Why did she think the problem was odd? Hmmmmm, well, because she wanted more sex than him. The woman wanted more sex than the man.

I don't know. Maybe this is not normal. She thinks – she thought it was not normal. She thought this was an odd problem. Was James healthy? Yes, James was healthy. He was a healthy man. He was a healthy male.

Did the woman work in an office? No, she didn't. She didn't work in an office. Did she work with the public? Yes, yes, she worked with the public. Did she work with the public, or did she work in an office? No, she worked with the public. Good.

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Was the woman beautiful? Yes, the woman was beautiful. How do we know the woman was beautiful? Hmmmmm, difficult question. How do we know the woman was beautiful? Ha, we know because many people told her.

Many people said she was beautiful. Many people told her she was beautiful. Right? She got many remarks saying she was beautiful. Did she get remarks many times? Yes, yes, she got remarks many times about being beautiful. Did she get only one remark? No, no, no, she got many remarks. She got frequent remarks.

Were these remarks bad or good? Well, the remarks were very good. Right? They said she was beautiful. The remarks were very good.

Did she want James to be more intimate? Yes, that is right. She wanted James to be more intimate. Did she want him to be more distant? No, no, not more far away,.. more close. She wanted him to be closer. Right, his emotions, his feelings... closer.

Did she want to have sex more with James? Yesssss, yes, she wanted to have sex more with James. Did she tell him she wanted to have sex more with him? Yes, she did. She told him she wanted to have sex more.

How did she tell him? Ah, how did she tell him? She wrote a letter. She wrote a letter telling him she wanted more sex with him. Did she write only one letter? No, no, she wrote more than one letter. She wrote more than one letter trying to communicate with him.

Was the woman frustrated? Frustrated, frustrated means upset. Yes, she was frustrated. She said, “I am at a total loss.” Right? “I don’t know what to do.” “I’m at a total loss. I am frustrated.”

Why was the woman frustrated? Well, she was frustrated because James was not intimate with her. Did she want advice from Abby? Yes, she wanted advice from Abby. What did she want from James? Well, she wanted to be more close to James. She wanted to be more intimate with James. She wanted to have more sex with James.

Did she want help, or was she satisfied? Well, she wanted help, right? She was not satisfied. She wanted help. Did she have enough intimacy from James? No, she did not have enough intimacy. She was short on intimacy.

Was she short on money? No, she was not short on money. What was she short on? She was short on intimacy. She was short on closeness. Maybe short on touching or short on sex,.... but she was short on intimacy.

Was James short on intimacy? No, no, James was okay. James was fine. Did James have a problem, or did the woman have a problem? Well, the woman had a problem. James didn’t have a problem.

Was the woman at a total loss, or was James at a total loss? The woman was at a total loss. She didn’t know what to do. Who was at a total loss? The woman. The woman was at a total loss.

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Why was she at a total loss? Ah, because she wanted more intimacy; but she didn't know how to get more intimacy from James.

Okay, that is all of mini-story A. Please listen to this mini-story many times. Answer every question every time. You can use your pause button. If necessary, use your pause button; but answer every question; and listen to this many times.

Okay. See you next time.

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Intimacy MS-B

Hello, welcome to mini-story B for Intimacy. In this mini-story, I will ask questions. Some questions you will know the answer. Just answer correctly. One word is okay, usually. Some questions you won't know the answer. If you don't know the answer, guess. You can guess anything. Okay, let's get started. Remember, answer every question.

Okay, in the letter, the woman says, "My husband, James, and I have been married only three years." What was the woman's name? Hmmmmm, was it Anna? Was it Alice? Was it Fredericka? Hmmmmm, her name was Alice or Anna or Fredericka? Well, her name was Anna. Anna was her name.

Or in America, we say Anna. Anna. Little bit different pronunciation. So Anna was the woman's name. Who was Anna married to? Anna was married to James. Was Anna happy with James? Noooooo, she was not happy with James.

Why was she not happy with James? Ah, because not enough sex from James, right? They did not have enough sex for her. She was not happy. Why did they not have enough sex for Anna? Oh, because Anna had a disease. She was sick. She had a special disease.

Why did Anna need to have a lot of sex for her disease? Well, Anna's special disease could only be cured by having sex every day. Could her disease be cured by medicine? Noooooo, Anna's disease could not be cured by medicine. Could her disease be cured by food? Noooooo, her disease could not be cured by food.

How could her disease be cured? Ah, her disease could only be cured by having sex every day. Was Anna young? Yes, Anna was young. She was in her 20s. Was James old? No, James was not old. He was also in his 20s.

Why did James not want to have sex with Anna? Oh, James also had a medical problem. He was also sick. What was James' medical problem? Oh, poor James was impotent. Impotent means cannot have sex. No power. It means no sexual power.

James had no sexual power. Ahhhhh, poor James. When did James have no sexual power? Ah, James had no sexual power at night. He had no sexual power only at night.

When did Anna want to have sex with James? Well, of course, she wanted to have sex with James at night. Who did she want to have sex with at night? She wanted to have sex with James at night.

Did she want to have sex with James during the day? During the day. Noooooo, she didn't want to have sex with James during the day. She wanted to have sex with James every night.

Why didn't Anna want to have sex during the day? Well, because she was working during the day. Right? She worked with the public every day. Did she work on Saturdays? Yes, she worked on Saturdays. Did she work on Sundays? Yes, she worked on Sundays. Did she work every day? Yes, she worked every day.

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Did she want to have sex during the day? No, she did not want to have sex during the day. When did Anna want to have sex? She wanted to have sex during the night or at night.

Could James have sex at night? No, poor James, he couldn't have sex at night. Why couldn't James have sex at night? Well, he couldn't have sex at night, because he had a disease. He had no sexual power at night.

Was this a problem? Yes, it was a problem. Why was it a problem? Ah, because Anna wanted sex only at night. Why did Anna want sex every night? Because she had a disease.

Would sex help the disease? Yes, sex would help the disease. Was Anna frustrated by this situation? Was she frustrated by this situation? Yes, Anna was very frustrated by this situation.

Was she at a total loss? Yes, she was at a total loss. Why was she at a total loss? Because she needed to have sex every night, but James couldn't have sex at night. He had no power at night.

Did Anna turn to her sister for advice? No, no, she didn't turn to her sister for advice. She didn't ask her sister for advice. Did she turn to her mother for advice? No, she didn't turn to her mother for advice.

Who did she turn to for advice? Actually, she turned to George Bush for advice. What did she ask George Bush? She asked George Bush, "How can I solve my sexual problem with my husband?"

Did she ask George Bush how to solve her problem with James? Yes, she asked George Bush how to solve her problem with James. Could George Bush help her? Noooooo, George Bush couldn't help her. Why couldn't George Bush help her? Well, because George Bush also has no sexual power.

Does George Bush have sexual power? Noooooo, George Bush has no sexual power. Could George Bush help Anna? Noooooo, he couldn't help Anna. Could George Bush help James? Noooooo, he couldn't help James. Why couldn't George Bush help James? Ah, because George Bush also had no sexual power.

Did Anna solve her problem? No, she didn't. How can Anna solve her problem? Can she take medicine to solve her problem? No, she can't. She can't. Can she have sex with James at night to solve her problem and be cured? No, she can't. James has no power at night.

So what must Anna do? Well, obviously, Anna needs to get a night job. Anna needs to change her job. If Anna changes her job, will she solve the problem? Yes, yes, of course. If Anna changes her job, she will solve the problem. If Anna gets a night job, she will solve the problem.

Who will solve the problem if she gets a night job? Well, Anna. Anna will solve the problem if she gets a night job. If she gets a night job, can she have sex with James during the day? Yes, yes, if she gets a night job, she can have sex with James during the day.

Does James have sexual power during the day? Yes, he has sexual power during the day; but he doesn't have sexual power at night. So what must Anna do? She must get a night job.

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Okay, that is all of mini-story B. Please listen to this mini-story many, many times. Every time, try to answer the questions. Use your pause button to answer the questions. Listen to this story every day, one time, two times, five times every day for two weeks or more. Answer, answer, answer all the questions.

Okay, see you next time. Bye-bye.

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Effortless English

1.7. **Secret Love**

WOMAN **HESITATES TO REVEAL** SECRET LOVE FOR **COLLEAGUE**

DEAR ABBY:

I am a single woman in my early 30s who has never been married. I recently fell in love with a wonderful man **with whom** I spend a great deal of time. He is **unaware** of the **intensity** of my feelings, and I'm afraid of telling him out of **fear of rejection**.

There are a couple of additional **concerns**: He is 15 years my **senior** and a medical doctor. I am a social worker in a lower **economic class**. In addition, we are of different religions, but we have similar spiritual beliefs and **values**. He is also my co-worker.

I am very interested in **pursuing a deeper relationship** with this man, but would like to hear your advice first. Thank you for your **thoughts** on this.

-- **LONGING FOR** MORE IN CHICAGO

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Effortless English

1.8. **The Race**

It's 5 o'clock and Allen is riding his motorcycle in San Francisco. He is riding down Van Ness street and comes to a **stop light**.

A red Ferrari **pulls up** next to him. The driver's wearing dark sun glasses. He **looks over** at Allen. Allen looks at him and realizes that the driver is Tom Cruise!

Tom **sneers** at Allen. He says, "When the light turns green, let's race".
Allen says, "Allright, **you're on**!"
Tom says, "I'm gonna **smoke you**, **sucka**!"
Allen says, "You wish. I'm gonna beat you and your **sorry-ass** car".

Allen and Tom wait at the light. They **rev their engines**.

Suddenly, the light turns green. Allen and Tom **take off**! They **zoom** down Van Ness at top speed. Tom is winning.

But suddenly, blue and red lights appear behind Tom-- its the police. They **pull him over**.

Allen zooms past Tom, laughing. He yells, "**Better luck next time**!"
Allen is the winner!

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LEVEL 2

2.1. **Bad Choices**

Publish Date: April 6, 2007

Dear Dr. Tracy,

I am a 33 year old **divorced** woman with four kids. I was married for 12 years and I have been divorced for **approximately** 3 years. I met my new boyfriend during my divorce. We **hit it off** and have been together ever since. He is a 44 year old divorced man. When I met him he had been divorced for 2 years. Well, I met his ex-wife and she seemed to be an okay person. What I found out 3 months into my relationship with him was that he was **fooling around with** his ex-wife again-- who also at this time had a boyfriend of her own. I **figured** that since I did not have **a committed relationship** with him, I **had no place to** say anything. The problem is it continued further into our relationship, up to the point when I found out I was pregnant. At the same time I found out that he and his ex-wife planned to go to his **family reunion** together. Of course before all of this, I drove by his house one night and saw her car parked outside his home. The **excuse** I got after all of this was that they were considering getting back together. I thought it was very funny that as soon as she met me, she found interest in him again.

I guess my **issue** is the fact that now I am still in this relationship. I have brought a child into this **nonsense** and I hate the fact that he keeps in contact with her. My boyfriend has taken responsibility for her son from a previous relationship. His **excuse** for having so much contact with his ex-wife is because of that boy. I know this is not true but I have no real proof otherwise. I have also **dealt with** him taking women to hotels and **my gut tells me** it was her, but he promises it was not her.

I have tried **to get over** all the cheating. I know that she is very close to his family and I also know that his family does not like me because I **stand up for myself.** I guess **the bottom line** is knowing how much contact his ex-wife has with him and the fact that he knows I **can't stand** her. Am I in a weird relationship with a man that **wants to have his cake and eat it too**? Or am I being **paranoid** and need to trust him when he says he does not want her. I have never had so much **animosity** towards two people in my life. I do love this man, but I feel like I have put myself back in an unhealthy relationship with a man that is trying to lie to me.

To be totally honest, now that I have his child I even hate the fact that he helps her son. She never has to ask for anything regarding that boy, but I have to constantly remind him when our son needs something. He does it for the other boy without thinking, but my son is a second thought even when I have said, "Look at your son. He is in **dire** need". I was married to a cheating man and **hooked up with** another cheating man. I wonder if it's just my bad choices in men.

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Effortless English

2.2. **Double Standard**

Publish Date: April 8, 2007

FAMILY IS UNEASY WHEN ONE SISTER DATES OTHER'S EX-LOVER

DEAR ABBY:

My sister, "Jane," and I are both in our mid-50s. Jane has had **numerous affairs** over the past several years after her third divorce, and was involved in an "**intimate relationship**" with a terrific man, "Will," that **lasted** about three months. Jane broke up with Will several months after she decided he **wasn't what she was looking for**, and she's presently engaged to be married to a very nice man ("Sam") and seems very happy.

I dated Will several times before he and Jane **became involved**. We weren't **intimate** at that time, and we started seeing each other again over the last month. This time we have fallen in love.

My problem is Jane is upset that Will and I are together and says I have "**betrayed**" her. She is worried about having her former and current lovers present at family gatherings, and our parents are also concerned. They say it's "just **weird**." The fact that my sister was **intimate** with Will doesn't bother me or Will, but it sure bothers them.

Abby, I have always been the "good girl" in the family and **bowed to their pressure**, but my relationship with Will is more than I could have ever imagined, and I don't want to give up my future happiness just to make my sister and my parents more comfortable. My adult children have all met and approve of Will and our relationship, but Jane and my parents **won't budge**. Any suggestions?

-- WANTS WILL IN WALLA WALLA, WASH.

DEAR WANTS WILL: Perhaps it's time to stop being the "good girl," begin acting like a woman who knows what she wants, and **confront** the **double standard** in your family. If your sister was "sophisticated" enough to have serial affairs, and your parents have been so **worldly** they have **turned a blind eye to it**, then they should all be adult enough to realize that you are entitled to your happiness, too.

Although this may make for some awkward first few family gatherings, as grown-ups, everyone should be able to **get past it**. But if they can't, you are going to have to decide whether you want this man, or to be a **people-pleaser** for the rest of your life.

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Double Standard MS

Welcome to the mini story for Double Standard. Let's get started. There is a badass marine named Serin. He has an intimate relationship with Julia Roberts. They are very, very close.

Serin likes Julia but one day he decides she's just not what he's looking for. He breaks up with Julia. Julia feels betrayed. She says "how can you do this to me? Why are you hurting me? Please take me back."

But Serin won't budge. He says "no I don't want you Julia". Julia can't get past the break-up. Every day she follows Serin. Every day she calls him.

At first, Serin turns a blind eye to her behavior but finally he can't ignore it anymore. He yells at Julia and says "I won't bow to this pressure. I won't take you back. So leave me alone." Julia asks "do you have another girlfriend".

He says "yes I'm dating Hilary Clinton now. She's rich and very powerful." "Really? Wow, I like her. I'm going to vote for her", says Julia.

She says, "I still feel a little uneasy but if you're dating Hilary I guess it's okay". Julia smiles and walks away. As she leaves she yells, "so is Bill free for dating?"

Okay one more time this time with questions. There is a bad ass marine named Serin -- bad ass ooh that's slang. Bad ass means tough, very strong -- tough, very good at what he does. So very strong and tough. There's a bad ass marine named Serin.

A marine is a kind of soldier, a kind of fighter. He has an intimate relationship with Julia Roberts. Are Serin and Julia Roberts only friends, just friends? No-no-no. They have an intimate relationship.

It means they're very close not only friends, they are dating each other. They have an intimate relationship. Are they probably having sex? Yes, probably they are. They have an intimate relationship.

They are dating. They're very, very close. Serin and Julia Roberts have an intimate relationship. Does Serin have an intimate relationship with Cameron Diaz? No-no.

He does not have an intimate relationship with Cameron Diaz. He has an intimate relationship with Julia Roberts. They are very, very close. Serin likes Julia but one day he decides she's just not what he's looking for. Does Serin want Julia?

No, he doesn't. He decides she's not what he's looking for. She's not really what -- she's not really what he wants. So he decides she's just not what he's looking for. Is Hilary Clinton what he's looking for? Yes, Hilary Clinton is what he's looking for.

She's rich and powerful that's what he's looking for. Serin's looking for rich and powerful. Julia Roberts is not powerful enough so she's not what he's looking for. Is Cameron Diaz what Serin

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is looking for? No, he doesn't want Cameron Diaz.

Cameron Diaz is not what he's looking for. What is Serin looking for? Serin is looking for a rich and powerful woman like Hilary Clinton so he breaks up with Julia. Julia feels betrayed. Does Julia feel he did something bad to her?

Yes, exactly she feels -- she feels he did something bad to her. They were close, she trusted him, and then he hurt her. Did Serin betray Cameron Diaz? No, he didn't betray Cameron Diaz. He never dated Cameron Diaz.

He never did anything bad to her. He did not betray Cameron Diaz. Did he betray Hilary Clinton? No, he did not. He did not hurt Hilary Clinton.

Did he betray Julia? Well, breaking up is not really betraying but Julia feels betrayed. She feels betrayed. Betrayed is the emotion e.d. feel betrayed. But really Serin did not betray her.

But anyway she says "how can you do this to me? Why are you hurting me? Please take me back". But Serin won't budge. Will Serin change his mind?

No, he won't budge. He won't change at all. Will he change a little bit? No, Serin will not change not even a little bit. He won't budge.

He won't change at all. Will Julia budge? No, she doesn't want to budge either. She wants him back one hundred percent. She doesn't want to change either.

So Julia won't budge and Serin won't budge. Serin says "no I don't want you Julia." But Julia says "yes I want you back." Neither one of them will budge. They won't budge.

Julia can't get passed the break-up. Can Julia forget the break-up? No she can't forget the break-up. She can't get past the break-up. Can Julia get past Mel Gibson?

Well, yeah she never dated Mel Gibson so she doesn't need to get past Mel Gibson. Who does she need to get past? Well, she needs to get past Serin. Serin is her ex-boyfriend. She needs to get past Serin.

Can she get past Serin? No-no. She can't get past him. She can get past Serin. She can't get past the break-up.

She's still upset. Is she still very sad about Serin and the break-up? Yes, that's right she's still very, very sad. She can't get past the break-up. So every day she follows Serin.

Every day she calls him on the phone. At first, Serin turns a blind eye to her behavior. In the beginning, does Serin get upset by her behavior? No-no. In the beginning, he turns a blind eye.

He ignores her. He pretends he doesn't see her. He pretends he's not bothered by her behavior. So he turns a blind eye to her behavior. Does Serin turn a blind eye to Cameron Diaz?

No, he doesn't ignore Cameron Diaz. Who does he turn a blind eye to? Well, he turns a blind

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eye to Julia Roberts. In fact, he turns a blind eye to her behavior. He ignores her behavior.

Does Julia turn a blind eye to Serin? No-no. She doesn't ignore him. She does not turn a blind eye to Serin. Serin turns a blind eye to her behavior but she does not turn a blind eye to Serin.

She keeps calling him. Finally, Serin can't ignore her anymore. He yells at Julia and says "I won't bow to this pressure." Will Serin do what Julia wants him to do? No -no, he won't.

He won't bow to the pressure. He will not change because of her pressure. Will he bow to Cameron Diaz' pressure? No, Cameron is not pressuring him. Cameron is just a friend.

She's not pressuring him. Julia is pressuring him. He won't bow to Julia's pressure. Will he date Julia again? No, he won't.

He won't bow to her pressure. He won't do what she wants. What does Julia want? Julia wants to date him again. So she's pressuring him "please date me again, please date me again, please date me again". Will he bow to this pressure?

No, he won't bow to this pressure. He says "I won't take you back. So leave me alone." Julia asks, "do you have another girlfriend". And he says, "yes I'm dating Hilary Clinton now".

She's rich and very powerful. Julia says "really. Wow, I like her. I'm going to vote for her. I still feel a little uneasy but if you're dating Hilary I guess I'm okay".

Does she feel a little uncomfortable about Hilary? Yes, that's right. She feels a little uneasy that he is dating Hilary. Is she very upset that Serin is dating Hilary? No-no-no.

She's not very upset she's just a little uneasy. She's uneasy. She's not very, very upset she's just uneasy. Why is Julia uneasy? Well, she's uneasy because Serin is dating a new girl.

But it's Hilary Clinton and she likes Hilary so she's only uneasy- not very upset. Is Serin uneasy? No, Serin's not uneasy. Serin is okay. He's dating Hilary and he's happy with Hilary.

So Serin is not uneasy about Hilary. Who is uneasy about Hilary? Well, Julia Roberts is a little uneasy about Hilary but just a little. It's not bad. And she says "well I'm going to vote for her so if you're dating Hilary it's okay."

Finally, she turns and walks away. When she's walking away Julia smiles and she yells to Serin, "so does this mean Bill Clinton is free for dating?"

Alright. Now one more time. This time I will pause after the key phrases. Please repeat the phrases after me but don't just repeat- copy my intonation. Copy my pronunciation. Try to speak exactly like me. Let's go.

There's a bad ass marine named Serin. [pause] There's a bad ass named Serin. [pause] He has an intimate relationship with Julia Roberts. [pause] He has an intimate relationship with Julia Roberts. [pause] They're very, very close.

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Serin likes Julia but one day he decides she's just not what he's looking for. [pause] She's just not what he's looking for. [pause] He breaks up with Julia. Julia feels betrayed. [pause] Julia feels betrayed. [pause]

She says "how can you do this to me? Why are you hurting me? Please take me back". But Serin won't budge. [pause] But Serin won't budge. [pause]

He says "no I don't want you Julia." Julia can't get past the break-up. [pause] Julia can't get past the break-up. [pause] Every day she follows Serin. Every day she calls him.

At first, Serin turns a blind eye to her behavior. [pause] At first, Serin turns a blind eye to her behavior. [pause] But finally he can't ignore it anymore. He yells at Julia and says "I won't bow to this pressure." [pause] I won't bow to this pressure. [pause]

"I won't take you back so please leave me alone". Julia asks "do you have another girlfriend". And Serin says "yes I'm dating Hilary Clinton now. She's rich and very powerful". Julia says "really? Wow, I like her. I'm going to vote for her."

I still feel a little uneasy. [pause] I still feel a little uneasy. [pause] But if you're dating Hilary I guess it's okay. Julia smiles and walks away. As she leaves she yells "so is Bill Clinton free for dating?" [pause]

Alright. That is all of the mini story. Now pause and try to tell all of the story yourself. You don't need to remember every word but try to use the new phrases and the new words correctly; if you cannot just relax and listen again. Listen to this story every day for one week or two weeks and you will internalize the new phrases. You'll also internalize a lot of basic grammar and a lot of basic pronunciation by listening again, and again, and again.

Alright. See you next time. Bye-bye.

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Double Standard POV

Same mini story but first starting with the phrase one year ago.

One year ago there was a bad ass marine named Serin. He had an intimate relationship with Julia Roberts. They were very, very close. Serin liked Julia but one day he decided she just wasn't what he was looking for.

So he broke up with her. Julia felt betrayed. She said "how can you do this to me? Why are you hurting me? Please take me back."

But Serin wouldn't budge. He said "no I don't want you Julia." Julia couldn't get past the break-up. Every day she followed Serin. Every day she called him.

At first, Serin turned a blind eye to her behavior. But finally he couldn't ignore it anymore. He yelled at Julia and said "I won't bow to this pressure. I won't take you back. So leave me alone." Julia asked "do you have another girlfriend."

And he said "yes I'm dating Hilary Clinton now. She's rich and very powerful." Julia said "really? Wow, I like her. I'm going to vote for her.

I still feel a little uneasy but if you're dating Hilary I guess it's okay." Julia smiled and walked away. As she left she yelled "so is Bill free for dating?"

Okay our next version is going to start with the phrase since 2004. Okay. Alright.

There's a bad ass marine named Serin. Since 2004 he has had an intimate relationship with Julia Roberts. They have been very, very close. Serin has liked Julia this whole time but one day he finally decided she just wasn't what he was looking for.

So he broke up with Julia. Julia felt betrayed. She said "how can you do this to me? Why are you hurting me? Please take me back."

But Serin wouldn't budge. He said "no I don't want you Julia." Julia couldn't get past the break-up. Every day she followed Serin. Every day she called him.

At first, Serin turned a blind eye to her behavior but finally he couldn't ignore it anymore. He yelled at Julia and said "I won't bow to this pressure. I won't take you back so leave me alone". Julia asked "do you have another girlfriend." And he said "yes I'm dating Hilary Clinton now. She's rich and very powerful. "

She said "really? Wow, I like her. I'm going to vote for her. I still feel a little uneasy but if you're dating Hilary I guess it's okay." Julia smiled and walked away. As she left she yelled "so is Bill free for dating?"

Alright. Our final version begins with the phrase "next year". Next year this is going to happen in the future. I'm imagining this. Here we go.

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There's a bad ass marine named Serin. Next year he'll have an intimate relationship with Julia Roberts. They'll be very close. Serin will like Julia but one day he'll decide she's just not what he's looking for. He'll break-up with Julia.

Julia will feel betrayed. She'll say "how can you do this to me? Why are you hurting me? Please take me back." But Serin isn't going to budge.

He's going to say "no I don't want you Julia". Julia won't be able to get past the break-up. Every day she'll follow Serin. Every day she'll call him. At first, Serin will turn a blind eye to her behavior but finally he won't be able to ignore it anymore.

He'll yell at Julia and say "I won't bow to this pressure. I won't take you back. So leave me alone." Julia will ask "do you have another girlfriend". He'll say "yes I'm dating Hilary Clinton now.

She's rich and very powerful." Julia will say "really? Wow, I like her. I'm going to vote for her. I still feel a little uneasy but if you're dating Hilary I guess it's okay."

Julia will smile and walk away. As she leaves, she's going to yell "so is Bill free for dating?"

Alright. And that's our final version in the future. Please go back now listen to each version and then pause. Try to tell each version yourself out loud. You don't need to be perfect.

You don't need to remember every word. But try your best and try to use the correct form of the verbs. Sometimes the vocabulary changes a little bit- listen for that. If you can't do it, if it's too difficult, no problem-- just relax. Listen to these versions many, many times.

Every day listen to it one time, two times, three times. The next day again. The next day again. It takes some time, but if you do this every month, every day, for one month, two months, six months, one year you will get a more natural feeling for English grammar.

Okay. See ya next time. Bye-bye.

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Effortless English

2.3. Greek Family

Publish Date: April 1, 2007

WOMAN WILL NEVER BE GREEK ENOUGH FOR HUSBAND'S FAMILY

DEAR ABBY:

I married a Greek man whose family never accepted me. Being young and **naive**, I tried everything to fit in, **converting** from Catholicism **to** the Greek Orthodox **faith**, attending all family functions, including them in our lives. It was never enough.

My husband and I traveled to Crete with his family to visit his **relatives** there, and some **extended family** members **refused to** share the dinner table with me because I was not Greek. One of those family members was a priest!

Our daughter, "Athena," was born four years later. What **broke the camel's back** for me was a Christmas dinner when she was 6. My father-in-law gave cards with $100 to all the grandchildren **of** Greek **heritage**. Athena received nothing and cried for hours wanting to know why her grandfather didn't love her. My husband just tried to stay **neutral**.

Abby, how far should someone have to go to fit in with their husband’s family?

-- IRISH AGAIN IN NEW HAMPSHIRE

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2.4. **Longtime Affair**

LONGTIME AFFAIR APPEARS SET TO LAST FOR LONG TIME TO COME

DEAR ABBY:

I'm married; he's married. We're in love and have been for eight years. We've tried **breaking it off** several times over the years, but a force bigger than both of us keeps bringing us back together.

I never believed in **soulmates** or true love until we met. Our love is deep and **unconditional**; our **roots** are **intertwined**. It's a shame that it happened late in life, but it happened nonetheless. He treats me like a queen.

Neither of us is leaving our spouses or family. We are both in our 50s and sometimes act like we're in our 20s. It's magical!

Is it wrong? Do we go on until something changes? Do we try for the 100th time to **break away**? An affair, **no matter how you slice it**, will never be accepted **in the eyes of** traditional society, so it will be **perceived** as unacceptable. What's your opinion?

-- **BEWITCHED**, **BOTHERED** AND **BEWILDERED** IN NEW YORK

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Longtime Affair MS

Hello. Welcome to the mini story for the Longtime Affair lesson. Let's get started. First, the mini story.

There is a very small man named Jim. Jim is only one foot tall. Even though Jim is forty-eight years old people always perceive him as a child. In the eyes of the public, Jim is a cute little boy. Jim hates this.

He says "I want people to accept me as I really am. I want them to give me unconditional respect. I don't want people to go on treating me like a child." So Jim goes to the gym and exercises every day. He becomes very strong.

He also learns kickboxing. One day a tall man sees him, laughs and says "you're such a cute little man, ha ha ha". Jim gets angry. He yells and he kicks the man. They start fighting.

The fight lasts for twenty hours. The mens' heads and legs and arms become intertwined. They fall down. Jim finally breaks away from the man. Then he jumps up, kicks him in the head and the man falls down. Jim wins the fight and yells "no matter how you slice it, I just kicked your ass".

Alright. Back to the beginning. This time with questions. Here we go.

There is a very small man named Jim. Is there a small woman named Jim? No, there's not a small woman named Jim, there's a small man named Jim. Jim is only one foot tall. How old is Jim?

Well, Jim is forty-eight years old. Even though he's forty-eight years old, people always perceive him as a child. Is Jim a child? No, he's not a child. People perceive him as a child.

They see him as a child. They see him and they think "oh he's a cute, little child" but he's not really a child. Is Jim a child or a man? Well, Jim is a man. Do people perceive him as a child or a man?

Well, people perceive him as a child. Who do people perceive as a child? Well, people perceive Jim as a child. Do people perceive Jim as a big, strong man? No, they don't perceive him as a big, strong man.

They don't see him as a big, strong man. They perceive him as a child. In the eyes of the public Jim is a cute, little boy. In the eyes of the public, is Jim a strong man? No, in the eyes of the public, in the public's opinion, in most people's opinion, Jim is a cute, little boy.

In the eyes of the public is George Bush a cute, little boy? No-no. In the eyes of the public George Bush is not a cute, little boy. In the eyes of the public Jim is a cute, little boy. In the eyes of his father, is Jim a cute, little boy?

No-no. His father doesn't think he's a little boy now. His father knows he's a man, a good, strong man. In the eyes of his father, Jim is a real man. But in the eyes of the public Jim is a cute, little boy.

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Alright. Jim hates this. He hates peoples' perception. He hates what people think about him. He says "I want people to accept me as I really am."

I want them to give me unconditional respect." Does Jim want total respect from everybody? Yes, that's right. He wants unconditional respect from everybody. Does Jim want unconditional love from everybody?

No, Jim doesn't want unconditional love. He doesn't want them to totally love him always. He wants unconditional respect. He wants people to always respect him in all situations, all the time. He wants unconditional respect.

Who wants unconditional respect? Well, Jim wants unconditional respect. Why does he want unconditional respect? Well, he wants unconditional respect because people perceive him as a child. He doesn't like this.

He wants unconditional respect. He doesn't want people to go on treating him like a child. He says "I don't want people to go on treating me like a child." Does he want people to continue to see him as a child? No, he doesn't want people to go on seeing him as a child.

Does he want people to go on seeing him as a little, weak person? No, he does not want people to continue doing that. He does not want people to go on doing that. Does he want people to go on treating him, seeing him, like a big, strong person? Well, he does want that- but people don't do that- so they can't go on doing that, right?

It can't continue because it's not happening already. It's not possible. They can't go on doing something if they aren't already doing it. To "go on" means to continue doing something that is already happening. So he says "I don't want people to go on treating me like a child" -- treating him like a child.

Do they treat him like an adult? No, they do not treat him like an adult. Do they treat him like a serious person? No, they don't treat him like a serious person. How do people treat Jim?

Well, people treat Jim like a child. They pretend he's a child, right? They behave as if he was a child. They treat him like a child. Do they treat him badly in a very cruel, mean, bad way?

Well, no they don't really treat him badly they just treat him like a child. They don't respect him. They treat him like a child. And so Jim gets upset. He goes to the gym to workout every day.

He exercises every day. He becomes very, very strong. He also learns kickboxing. One day a tall man sees him and laughs and says "ha ha ha you're such a cute, litte man." Jim gets very angry.

He yells and he kicks the man. They start fighting. The fight lasts for twenty hours. Does the fight last for fifteen hours? No, it does not last for fifteen hours.

Does the fight last for ten hours? No, the fight does not last for ten hours. It does not last for

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fifteen hours. How long does the fight last? Well, the fight lasts... the fight continues for twenty hours.

How long is the fight? Well, the fight is twenty hours long. The fight lasts for twenty hours. What lasts for twenty hours? Well, the fight lasts for twenty hours. The mens' hands and legs become intertwined during the fight and they fall down.

Do their hands and legs become wrapped around each other-- connected to each other? Yes, that's right-- their hands and legs become intertwined. They are wrapped around each other, stuck together. They become intertwined. Do their fingers become intertwined?

No-no, not their fingers. Their fingers do not become intertwined -- do not become wrapped around each other. Do their ears become intertwined? No-no maybe that's not possible, right? Their ears do not become intertwined.

Do their hands and legs become intertwined? Yes, that's right, their hands and their legs wrap around each other. Their hands and legs become intertwined. Do their necks become intertwined? Actually, yes their necks wrap around each other.

Their heads and necks stick together also. They all become intertwined- their hands, their legs, their necks and head. They wrap around each other. They're stuck together and they fall down. But finally Jim breaks away from the big man.

Does Jim get free from the big man? Yeah, that's right he gets free. He breaks away from the man. Are Jim's hands and legs still intertwined? No, they're not, he breaks free.

Right? They're not connected anymore. They're not wrapped around each other anymore. He breaks free. Jim breaks free from the other man.

Does Jim break free from a woman? No-no. He breaks free from the other man. After Jim breaks free, what does he do? Well, after Jim breaks free he jumps up and kicks the man in the head. Boom. The man falls down unconscious.

Jim wins the fight and he yells "no matter how you slice it I just kicked your ass." Alright. "No matter how you slice it" means-- no matter what your opinion, no matter how you look at it, any angle, any way you look at it, any opinion, everybody will agree-- Jim kicked his ass. And of course "kicked your ass" means to beat somebody, to win against them. Okay.

So no matter how you slice it, did Jim lose? No. No matter how you slice it, any opinion will agree, Jim won the fight. No matter how you slice it, is George Bush an idiot?Yes, that's right-- everybody agrees that George Bush is an idiot.

No matter how you slice it, any way you look at it, any opinion, everybody agrees George Bush is an idiot. No matter how you slice it, is Jim a strong man? Yeah, that's right, I think so. No matter who you slice it, Jim is a strong guy. He's a tough guy.

Everybody agrees now- no matter how you slice it- Jim is a strong guy. Did Jim kick the

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man's ass? Yes, he did. Jim kicked his ass. Who's ass did Jim kick?

Well, Jim kicked the big man's ass. The big man from the gym, right? He kicked his ass. Does everybody agree that Jim kicked his ass? Yeah, everybody agrees- no matter how you slice it, Jim won the fight. Jim kicked his ass.

Alright. Very good. Let's go on. Back to the top again. This time I will pause after the key words or phrases. Please copy my pronunciation. This is not a grammar exercise. This is a pronunciation exercise. So please focus on pronunciation. Here we go.

There is a very small man named Jim. Jim is only one foot tall. Even though Jim is forty-eight years old people always perceive him as a child. [pause] People always perceive him as a child. [pause] In the eyes of the public, Jim is just a cute, little boy. [pause] In the eyes of the public, Jim is just a cute, little boy. [pause]

Jim hates this. He says "I want people to accept me as I really am. I want them to give me unconditional respect." [pause] I want them to give me unconditional respect. [pause] He says "I don't want people to go on treating me like a child". [pause] I don't want people to go on treating me like a child. [pause]

So Jim goes to the gym and exercises every day. He becomes very strong. He also learns kickboxing. One day a tall, big man sees him and laughs and says "you're such a cute, little man, ha ha ha." Jim gets angry.

He yells and says "I'm going to kick your ass." He kicks the man. They start fighting. The fight lasts for twenty hours. [pause] The fight lasts for twenty hours. [pause]

The mens' hands and legs become intertwined. [pause] The mens' hands and legs become intertwined. [pause] They fall down. Jim finally breaks away from the man. [pause] Jim finally breaks away from the man. [pause]

Then he jumps up and kicks the man in the head. Jim wins the fight and he yells "no matter how you slice it I just kicked your ass." [pause] No matter how you sliced it I just kicked your ass. [pause]

Alright. Very good. Please pause now. Try to tell all of the story yourself. Tell everything yourself. If you can't remember- relax, go back, listen again.

Alright. Now for the POV, point of view stories next.

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Longtime Affair POV

Okay. Welcome to the POV Mini Stories, Point of View Mini Stories for the Longtime Affair lesson-- same story different versions. Let's start. First, we go to the past- ten years ago.

Ten years ago there was a very small man named Jim. Jim was only one foot tall. Even though Jim was forty-eight years old, people always perceived him as a child. In the eyes of the public, Jim was just a cute little boy. Jim hated this.

He said "I want people to accept me as I really am. I want them to give me unconditional respect. I don't want people to go on treating me like a child." So Jim went to the gym and exercised every day. He became very strong.

He also learned kickboxing. One day a tall man saw him, laughed and said "you're such a cute little man, ha ha ha." Jim got angry. He yelled and said "I'm going to kick your ass." He kicked the man. They started to fight.

The fight lasted for twenty hours. The men's' hands and legs became intertwined and they fell down. Jim finally broke free from the man. Then he jumped up and kicked the man in the head. Jim won the fight and he yelled "no matter how you slice it I just kicked your ass."

Alright. That's our past version. Now let's move to the perfect version, we call it, I guess. Here we go.

Since last year -- okay. There's a very small man named Jim. Jim is only one foot tall. Even though Jim is forty-eight years old people have always perceived him as a child. In the eyes of the public, Jim has always been just a cute little boy. Jim has always hated this.

But since last year he has become very upset. Every day he has said "I want people to accept me as I really am. I want them to give me unconditional respect. I don't want people to go on treating me as a child." And so, since last year, Jim has gone to the gym and has exercised every day. He has become very strong.

He has also learned kickboxing. Well, one day a tall big man saw him and laughed and said "you're such a cute little man, ha ha ha." Jim got angry. He yelled and he kicked the man. They started to fight.

The fight lasted for twenty hours. The men's' hands and legs became intertwined and they fell down. Jim finally broke away from the man. Then he jumped up and kicked him in the head. Jim won the fight and he yelled "no matter how you slice it I just kicked your ass. "

Alright. In that version you noticed that we used the, we call it the present perfect, it doesn't matter, you don't need to know the name of the grammar. But we used that form that "have gone" "have been" form-- because it's something that has continued through the past for awhile -- started in the past, kept going for awhile. For example, people have always perceived him as a child. That's been happening for a long time-- starting when he was young until now, people continue to perceive him -- have continued to perceive him-- as a child.

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Alright. It started in the past and it kept going for awhile. And then again we talked about going to the gym. Since last year Jim has gone to the gym. He has exercised every day. Alright? Starting last year, up until now.

And then finally we changed to the past tense because we're talking about one specific event, the fight. Right? That happened in the past, it's over, it was just a short event in the past started, finished in the past, it's done. It's not a long time period, it's very short and complete. So we use the simple past for that.

That's all you need to know about grammar. Don't think too much about the grammar. Alright. Onto version number three-- into the future. Okay this is -- we can imagine this is my idea for a movie.

And I'm telling you the story-- what I think should happen, what I think will happen in this movie. Here's my movie idea, in the future ten years from now.

Ten years from now, there will be a very small man named Jim. Jim'll only be one foot tall. Even though he'll only be forty-eight years old, people will think he's a child. People will perceive him as a child. In the eyes of the public, Jim'll be a cute little boy only. Jim'll hate this.

He's going to say "I want people to accept me as I really am. I want them to give me unconditional respect. I don't want people to go on treating me like a child." Jim'll go to the gym and exercise every day. He'll become very strong.

He'll also learn kickboxing. One day a tall man's going to challenge him and laugh and say "you're such a cute little man, ha ha ha." Jim'll get angry. He'll yell and he'll kick the man. They'll start fighting.

The fight is going to last twenty hours. The men's' hands and legs will become intertwined and they'll fall down. Jim'll finally break away from the man and then he'll jump up and kick him in the head. Jim'll win the fight and he'll yell "no matter how you slice it I just kicked your ass."

Okay. The future is fairly simple. It's pretty easy. You guys have learned going to and will; however in normal speech we do not say going to and will we change the pronunciation. We say ull instead of will we say ull -- Jim'll -- the man'll -- the man'll challenge him.

Jim'll fight him. We don't say Jim will we say Jim'll. We just add the ull sound to the subject. And the other thing we do instead of "going to" we say gonna. Jim's gonna get angry not Jim is going to get angry.

Jim's gonna. Jim's za za you need the za sound there. "Jim's gonna" equals "Jim is going to." Jim's gonna. Alright. And that's how we actually use the future in normal speech. So when you hear "gonna" when you hear "ull" that means the future.

Okay. Please go back, listen to each section, pause, and try to tell that version yourself. Try to tell the story using the past- ten years ago. Try it ago with since last year. And then try it again in

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the future.

If you have trouble, if it's difficult, relax- this takes time. Just relax, go back, listen again. Go back listen again. Listen, listen, listen very carefully. Hear how the verbs change.

Hear how the vocabulary changes sometimes. Listen carefully- that's the most important part. Don't get upset if you can't tell the story yourself, it's okay. That will take time- listening is the most important part.

Alright. I will see ya next time. Go on and listen to the commentary. Bye-bye.

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Effortless English

2.5. **Lost Custody**

Publish Date: March 20, 2007

YOUNG MOTHER IS **FRIGHTENED** BY **THREAT** OF LOST **CUSTODY**

DEAR ABBY:

I am 22 years old and have been married 17 months. "Derek" and I have a 23-month-old son. Derek hasn't worked for about a year and refuses to help support our family. He also **belittles** me whenever he talks to me. I am not happy in this marriage, but I am not sure what to do about it.

On our honeymoon, Derek told me if I ever divorced him that he'd make sure he would get **custody** of our son. And his mom already said that she would tell the judge that I was an **unfit** mother.

My son is my world, Abby. He doesn't even let his daddy hold him, so I know he wouldn't **be better off** with Derek. But because I am **on disability**, I don't know if I have a good chance of getting custody if I leave. I don't feel Derek loves me or my son.

What should I do? **Stick it out** with my husband or take the chance of losing my son?

-- **TRAPPED** IN NEW HAMPSHIRE

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Effortless English

2.6. Meddling Mother-In-Law

Publish Date: March 12, 2007

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http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

WIFE READY TO **WASH HER HANDS OF MEDDLING MOTHER-IN-LAW**

DEAR ABBY:

How do I politely tell my mother-in-law to stop doing my **laundry**? It all started when I was **on bed rest due to** my pregnancy. I didn't mind her doing an occasional **load** to help us out. But now she does it anytime **she's over to** watch the kids.

I'm very **picky** about how I do my laundry, and this is the main reason I don't want her doing it. Also, I'd prefer she spend time playing with the kids than with the laundry!

She also puts things away in the wrong places. She does it with my dishes, too. Once I told her not to worry about my laundry because I wasn't done **sorting** it. She **took it upon herself** to do it anyway.

She's very **strong-willed**. My husband and I have had problems with her not respecting our **parenting**, too. She often **takes things the wrong way**. What's the best way for us to tell her that her help is not needed?

-- DIRTY FAMILY LAUNDRY

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Meddling Mother-In-Law MS

Hello, this is the mini-story lesson for the Meddling Mother-In-Law, Dear Abby lesson. Here we go.

There was a girl named Tomoe. One day, she took it upon herself to change her husband. Tomoe was very picky. She wanted the apartment to always be perfectly clean, but her husband was a lousy housekeeper. One day, Tomoe said, “When you do the laundry, please sort the clothes by color.” Tomoe was very polite, but her husband took this the wrong way. He yelled, “Why are you criticizing me? Why do you hate me? I’m not a lousy husband.” Then he jumped up and down, pulled his hair, and said, “I wash my hands of this. I will never do laundry again.”

Okay, let’s go back to the top – this time with questions. You can pause and answer the questions, or you can answer the question quickly in your head. Here I go. Or just listen.

There was a girl named Tomoe. One day, she took it upon herself to change her husband. Did somebody tell Tomoe to change her husband? No, no, nobody told her. She took it upon herself. Did Tomoe decide by herself to do this, to change her husband? That’s right. She decided all alone. She decided herself, “I will change my husband.”

Did she take it upon herself to change her mother? No, no, no, she didn’t decide alone to change her mother. She decided, by herself, to change her husband. She took it upon herself to change her husband. Did she take it upon herself to clean the house? No, she didn’t take it upon herself to clean the house. She didn’t decide, “Ah, I will clean the house.” No, she took it upon herself to change her husband.

What did she take it upon herself to do? Well, she took it upon herself to change her husband. Why did she take it upon herself to change her husband? Well, her husband was a lousy housekeeper. He was a bad housekeeper. He didn’t clean the house very much. So she took it upon herself – she decided herself – to change him. She didn’t ask anybody else.

Tomoe was very picky. She wanted the apartment to always be perfectly clean. Was Tomoe very relaxed about the apartment? No, no, no, no, she was not relaxed. She was very picky. Everything had to be perfect. Everything must be perfect, exactly as she wants it, exactly like she wants it.

Was Tomoe picky about her food? Must she always eat food that is perfect, exactly how she wants it? No, no, no, Tamoa’s not picky about her food. She will eat any kind of food. So no problem. She’s not picky about her food. Is Tomoe picky about her clothes? Was she picky about her clothes? Well, no, no, she doesn’t care about clothes. She doesn’t care about fashion. She will wear anything.

What was she picky about? Well, Tomoe was picky about the apartment, right? Everything in the apartment must be clean. Everything must be in the right place. Tommoe was very, very picky about the apartment, not about her food, not about clothes, not about other things. She’s very picky – was very picky about the apartment.

But her husband was a lousy housekeeper. Was he a good housekeeper? No, no, no, no, he was a very bad housekeeper. Did he clean the apartment a lot? No, no, he was a lousy housekeeper. He

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never cleaned the apartment. Did he do the laundry a lot? No, no, no, he never did the laundry. Was he good at doing the laundry? No, no, he was lousy. He was bad at doing the laundry.

Was he good with washing the dishes? No, no, he was lousy with the dishes, too. He was a lousy housekeeper in general. He was lousy with housekeeping. He was a lousy housekeeper.

So, finally, one day Tomoe said, “When you do the laundry, please sort the clothes by color.” Did she want him to pick out the different clothes – to separate them and organize them by color? Yes, yes, of course. That’s exactly what she wanted. She wanted him to sort the clothes by color. Did she want him to sort the clothes by size? Big ones here, small ones there. No, no, no, she didn’t want him to sort the clothes by size.

Did she want him to sort the dishes by color? No, no, no, no, she did not want him to sort the dishes – the plates, the bowls, no. She did not want him to sort the dishes. She wanted him to sort the clothes. How did she want him to sort the clothes? Well, she wanted him to sort the clothes by color. That’s how. She wanted him to sort the clothes by color.

Okay, so she wanted him to sort the clothes by color. When she said this, she was very polite, very nice. Tomoe was very polite always, but her husband took this the wrong way. Did her husband understand Tomoe exactly? No, no, he did not understand. He thought she was angry. He thought she was criticizing him. She – he thought she was attacking him. He took this the wrong way. He took her words the wrong way.

She said, “When you do the laundry, please sort the clothes by color.” But her husband took this the wrong way. He misunderstood the words. Did her husband take this the wrong way? Take her words the wrong way? Yes, of course, exactly right. He took her words the wrong way.

Did her mother take it the wrong way? No, no, no, no, not her mother. She wasn’t talking to her mother. Her mother didn’t take it the wrong way. Her husband took it the wrong way. What did her husband take the wrong way? Well, her husband took her words the wrong way. When she said, “Please sort the clothes by color,” he took that the wrong way.

After he took it the wrong way, what did he do? Well, he took it the wrong way; then he yelled, “Why are you criticizing me? Why do you hate me? I’m not a lousy husband.” Did he think he was a bad husband? No, no, no, he said, “I’m not a lousy husband. I am not a bad husband. I’m not a terrible husband.” So he said, “I’m not a lousy husband.” He didn’t think he was a lousy husband.

Did Tomoe say he was a lousy husband? No, of course not. Tomoe’s polite. She didn’t say that. She didn’t say, “You are a lousy husband.” She only said, “Please sort the clothes by color.” But he took that the wrong way. Then he jumped up and down. He pulled his hair; and he said, “I wash my hands of this. I will never do laundry again.”

Did her husband wash his hands of doing the dishes? No, no, no, no, he didn’t decide never to do the dishes. He will continue to do the dishes. He washed his hands of doing the laundry. Did he wash his hands of all housekeeping? No, no, he didn’t wash his hands of all housekeeping. He didn’t quit all housekeeping. He will still do some other things, but he washed his hands of doing the laundry.

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Will he ever do the laundry again? Will he ever do laundry again? No, absolutely not, no. He will never do laundry again. He washed his hands of doing laundry. He said, “I wash my hands of laundry.” Yep, it means he will never do laundry again. He will never help with laundry again. He will never touch laundry again. Never.

Did he wash his hands of the relationship of his marriage? No, no, no, of course not. He didn’t quit his relationship. He didn’t quit his marriage. He said, “I wash my hands of laundry.” He will never do laundry again.

Okay, very good. One more time up to the top. This time, if you want, if you want to practice speaking, I will pause after the key phrases. Please repeat them. When you repeat, copy my pronunciation; especially copy my intonation. When do I go up? When do I go down? And, remember, in English, we start high, ahhhhh, and we drop, ahhhhh, ahhhhh. So listen for that and copy it exactly. Here we go.

There was a girl named Tomoe. One day, she took it upon herself to change her husband. (Pause) One day, she took it upon herself to change her husband. (Pause) Very good. Tomoe was very picky. (Pause) Tomoe was very picky. (Pause) Good. She wanted the apartment to always be perfectly clean, but her husband was a lousy housekeeper. (Pause) But her husband was a lousy housekeeper. (Pause) Good.

One day, Tomoe said, “When you do the laundry, please sort the clothes by color.” (Pause) Very good. “Please sort the clothes by color.” (Pause) Good. Tomoe was very polite, but her husband took this the wrong way. (Pause) Good. But her husband took this the wrong way. (Pause) Very good.

He yelled, “Why are you criticizing me? Why do you hate me? I’m not a lousy husband.” (Pause) Good. “I’m not a lousy husband.” (Pause) Very good. Then he jumped up and down, pulled his hair, and said, “I wash my hands of this.” (Pause) Good. “I wash my hands of this.” (Pause) Very good. “I wash my hands of this. I will never do laundry again.”

Okay, that is all. Now please pause or stop this and try to tell all of the story yourself. Use all of the new phrases, all of the key phrases; and try to tell all of the story. If you can’t, don’t worry. Relax. Just listen again. Try to listen to it every day.

See you next time. Bye-bye.

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Meddling Mother-In-Law POV

Hello, welcome to the point of view mini-story for the Meddling Mother-In-Law lesson. Let's get started in our first version of the story. We will start with the phrase "Right now." Okay? The original story was in the past, so now we're gonna start with "Right now."

Right now, there is a girl named Tomoe. She takes it upon herself to change her husband. Tomoe is very picky. She wants the apartment to always be perfectly clean, but her husband is a lousy housekeeper. One day, Tomoe says, "When you do laundry, please sort the clothes by color." Tomoe is very polite, but her husband takes this the wrong way. He yells, "Why are you criticizing me? Why do you hate me? I'm not a lousy husband." Then he jumps up and down, pulls his hair, and says, "I wash my hands of this. I will never do laundry again."

All right, very good. Now let's change the story a little bit. We're gonna start the story with the phrase "Since last April." Starting in last April, continuing until now. Since last April. Okay.

There's a girl named Tomoe. Since last April, she has taken it upon herself to change her husband. Since that time, Tomoe has been very, very picky. She has wanted the apartment to always be perfectly clean, but her husband has always been a lousy housekeeper. One day, Tomoe said, "When you do the laundry, please sort the clothes by color." At that time, Tomoe was very polite; but her husband took it the wrong way. He yelled, "Why are you criticizing me? Why do you hate me? I'm not a lousy husband." Then he jumped up and down, pulled his hair, and said, "I wash my hands of this. I will never do laundry again."

Okay, did you notice, again, this happens a lot when we begin something with the perfect tenses. We often switch to another tense, often to the past tense. So we talked about one day – I'm sorry, I didn't say one day. Tomoe has taken it upon herself to change her husband. It means she started trying to change him last April. She has continued trying to change him until now, or until this day where they had the argument.

Right, it started in the past; and it continued. So we say, "She has taken it upon herself." Has taken. And we say, "Tomoe has been very picky." This gives the idea that something changed. Maybe in April, something happened; because, before April, maybe she wasn't picky; but since April, she has been very picky. Starting in April until now. You get the idea. But then when I say, "One day, Tomoe said," okay, one day is your clue. One day tells you, "Aha, it happened; and it's finished; so switch to the past tense."

All right, and now let's do our little – we can imagine we're telling a story about the future. Maybe it's a movie idea. Maybe it's any kind of story; but that's going to happen. Here we go.

There will be a girl named Tomoe. One day in the future, she will take it upon herself to change her husband. Tomoe'll be very picky. She'll want the apartment to always be perfectly clean, but her husband'll be a lousy housekeeper. One day, Tomoe'll say, "When you do laundry, please sort the clothes by color." Tomoe will be very polite, but her husband will take it the wrong way. He'll yell, "Why are you criticizing me? Why do you hate me? I'm not a lousy husband." Then he'll jump up and down, pull his hair, and say, "I wash my hands of this. I'll never do laundry again."

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Okay, in that story, you heard – sometimes it's hard to hear the future, right? In the textbooks they tell you to say will – will – will – will. He will do this. He will yell. I will go. But, in fact, when we speak, we don't usually say will. Right? We put – we combine it. We just say 'll, 'll. There'll be a girl named Tomoe. Right? There will be a girl. There'll – there'll – there'll be a girl.

One day, she'll take it upon herself. Right? Not she will. She'll. It's a contraction. We're putting the two sounds together. Tomoe'll be very picky. Right? Instead of saying Tomoe will be very picky, we can say, "Tomoe'll be very picky." Right? We cut off the W I. Instead of saying "wi," we just say 'll." Tomoe'll be very picky.

She'll want the apartment to be clean always. Not she will. She'll. Her husband'll be a lousy housekeeper. Not her husband will be. Her husband'll – husband'll. Okay? Now this is not correct for writing. With writing, we don't usually say husband'll; but in speech, in conversation, especially native speakers speaking quickly, they will say 'll – 'll. Her husband'll be very bad. Her husband'll be a bad housekeeper.

One day, Tomoe'll say, Tomoe'll say – did you hear that? Tomoe'll say – not Tomoe will say. Tomoe'll say – then we switch to the present tense; because it's a quote. "When you do laundry, please sort the clothes by color." Tomoe'll be very polite. Tomoe'll – Tomoe'll be very polite, but her husband'll take it the wrong way. Her husband will take it the wrong way. He'll yell, not he will yell. He'll yell, "Why are you criticizing me?" Etc., etc. Then he'll jump up and down. He'll pull his hair, and will say – and'll say – you could even do that. And'll say – and'll say – and will say, "I wash my hands of this. I will never do laundry again."

So listen for that. You know, the English you get in textbooks, in CD – on CDs, in schools, it's a formal style of English. It's also really a written kind of English. So you're learning to speak written English from these books; and, you know, that's okay; but it's not how we really speak. It is not how Americans actually speak.

You'll never see in a textbook husband'll. The husband'll be good. The husband'll go to the store. You'll never see that in the textbook; but, in fact, that's exactly what we say every day – husband'll. Tomoe'll. He'll. So listen for that when you listen to our movie lessons, when you listen to my commentaries, when you listen to these mini-stories. I'll try to use this more normal conversation style so you can begin to understand it and use it.

Okay, that's all. As usual, listen to each version. Then pause and try to tell the story yourself. All of it using the correct grammar, the correct verb tenses; and try to use the correct pronunciation when you do this future one, especially. Try to use 'll – 'll – 'll instead of will.

Okay, see you next time. Bye-bye.

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2.7.**Nudist**

NEIGHBORS GET AN EYEFUL WHEN NUDIST STEPS OUTSIDE

DEAR ABBY:

We have a male neighbor I'll call "Flash" who frequently walks out to get his newspaper -- or the mail, or to **retrieve** something from his car -- while he's as naked as the day he was born. (He's in his late 50s and divorced.)

Some of the women in the neighborhood know not to look toward Flash's home if they're out for a walk. They have discovered that he is most likely **in the buff**, standing at his glass door or sitting at his front office computer with the door open.

Flash is otherwise a likable and helpful neighbor. We **hesitate** to say anything. We do not want to say anything that might destroy that relationship. It's not against the law to be a nudist, or for a woman to go topless in public in this city. However, to see a **fella streak** to his car is a little surprising and **unsettling**, even for another adult.

In the normal **course** of things, he may be **spotted in the nude** once a week. I can only assume this goes on daily, but thankfully, our **paths don't cross** more than once a week. Is this something we should be concerned about?

-- **STARTLED** IN AUSTIN, TEXAS

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2.8. **Obsessive Behavior**

Publish Date: March 23, 2007

PARENTS DENY PROBABLE CAUSE OF SON'S OBSESSIVE BEHAVIOR

DEAR ABBY:

My nephew, "Vincent," is 16 and has had problems with **obsessive** handwashing for years. I have enough professional experience to strongly suspect that he suffers from obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD).

My brother and his wife **refuse** to believe their child has a problem and will not take him to get help. My nephew's hands are **chafed** and raw, and his parents **reprimand** him for this behavior when he really needs professional help.

His mother is the biggest problem. She **nixes** all issues that suggest a problem, and my brother will not **stand up to** her. What can I do?

-- WORRIED AUNT IN FLORIDA

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Obsessive Behavior MS

Okay, welcome to the mini-story for Obsessive Behavior lesson. Let's get started.

Cathy always obsesses about English. She constantly worries about taking the TOEFL test. When she worries, she always rubs her hands together. They are always chaffed. Her friend, Gabriel, is the opposite. He always opts to remain relaxed. He always reprimands Cathy. "Cathy, stop obsessing about English, damn it." Cathy never stands up to Gabriel directly. She just says, "I'm sorry. Please don't be mad." Then she says, "Um, but let's go the library now and study English, please." Gabriel always nixes this idea. "Hell, no, we're not studying English." Cathy feels unsettled; but she says, hesitantly, "Okay." However, in her head, she silently starts to review English grammar. Then she feels much better.

Okay, again, this time with questions. Back to the top.

Cathy always obsesses about English. Does she think about English all the time? Yes, that's right. She always thinks about English. Does she think about English in the morning? Yeah, that's right. She always obsesses about English in the morning. Does she think about English during the day? Yes, that's right. She's obsessing about English, right? Always obsesses about English; so she thinks about English in the morning, in the afternoon, at night before she goes to sleep. She obsesses about English.

Does she obsess about French? No, no, no, she doesn't care about French. She doesn't always think about French. She obsesses about English. Who always obsesses about English? Well, Cathy always obsesses about English. Does Gabriel always obsess about English? No, no, Gabriel doesn't always obsess about English. Cathy always obsesses about English.

She constantly worries about taking the TOEFL test. Does she obsess about the TOEFL test? Yes, yes, she's always obsessed with the TOEFL test. She always obsesses about the TOEFL test. When she worries, she always rubs her hands together. Right? She's always rubbing her hands together when she worries about English, when she obsesses about English.

Because she always rubs her hands together, they are always chaffed. Are her hands always red? Yes, that's right. Her hands are always chaffed. The skin is always red. Is the skin always a little painful? Yeah, that's right. Her hands are always chaffed, so her hands are always a little painful. The skin is painful. The skin is a little bit red. Why are her hands always chaffed? Well, they're always chaffed because she rubs them together when she worries – when she worries about English.

Are they chaffed because she washes her hands too much? No, no, that's not why they're chaffed. Her hands are not chaffed because she washes her hands too much. They're chaffed because she rubs her hands together too much. They're chaffed because she rubs her hands together. That's why they're red and painful.

Now, her friend, Gabriel, is the opposite. He always opts to remain relaxed. Does he choose to remain relaxed? Yeah, that's right. He opts to be relaxed. He chooses to be relaxed. To opt to means to choose. Now, we usually use opt to with an action. Opt to run. Opt to go shopping. Opt

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to stay relaxed. It goes with the verb. If you're choosing two things, if you have a red phone and a blue phone, you don't say, "I opt the red phone."

You might say, "I opt for the red phone." If you say that, then it's okay; but, usually, we use it with verbs. You opt to do something. I opt to buy the red phone. We would say that. That would be okay. So he opts to stay relaxed. Does Cathy opt to stay relaxed? Does she choose to be relaxed? No, Cathy does not opt to stay relaxed. She always opts to be worried. She always obsesses about English, but Gabriel opts to remain relaxed.

He chooses to remain relaxed, and he always reprimands Cathy. Does he criticize Cathy's obsession? Obsession's a noun. Does he criticize Cathy's obsession – Cathy's worrying? Yeah, that's right. He reprimands Cathy. Does he tell her she's wrong, that she's doing something bad? Yeah, that's right. He reprimands Cathy. He tells her, "Stop obsessing about English, damn it." Right? He reprimands her.

He criticizes her and tells her she's doing something wrong. Does Gabriel reprimand his mother? No, no, Gabriel does not reprimand his mother. Who does Gabriel reprimand? Gabriel reprimands Cathy. Why does he reprimand Cathy? Well, he reprimands Cathy because she worries about English too much. She obsesses about English.

Does he reprimand Cathy all the time? Well, no, he doesn't reprimand Cathy all the time. When does he reprimand Cathy? Well, he reprimands Cathy when she talks about English, when she wants to study English, and when she rubs her hands together. Then he reprimands her.

How does he reprimand her? What does he say? Well, he reprimands her by saying, "Cathy, stop obsessing about English, damn it." But Cathy never stands up to Gabriel. Does Cathy argue with Gabriel? No, no, she does not stand up to Gabriel. Does she disagree with Gabriel directly? No, no, she never says something to him. She never disagrees. She never argues. She does not stand up to Gabriel.

Does Cathy stand up to other people? Well, we don't know. Maybe she stands up to other people. Maybe she will argue with her mom or her other friends, but she won't stand up to Gabriel. When Gabriel reprimands her, does she stand up to him? No, she doesn't. She does not stand up to Gabriel. He says, "Stop obsessing about English," while she doesn't argue with him.

What does she say? Since she doesn't stand up to him, she just says, "I'm sorry. Please don't be mad." But then later she says, "Um, but, um, let's go the library now and study English, please." Gabriel gets angry. Gabriel always nixes this idea. Does Gabriel agree with the idea? No, no, he nixes the idea, right? He shoots the idea down. He destroys the idea. He immediately says no. He says, "No, we are not studying English." He nixes the idea.

Does he nix all of Cathy's ideas? No, no, no, he doesn't nix all of Cathy's ideas. He only nixes her idea to study English. When she wants to study English, he always nixes the idea. He always says no immediately. "No, we're not studying English."

Does Gabriel nix Bob's idea? No, no, no, he doesn't nix Bob's idea. He nixes Cathy's idea, right? Gabriel nixes Cathy's idea, not Bob's idea; and when he nixes her idea, what does he say? Well,

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Gabriel always nixes the idea and says, “Hell, no, we’re not studying English.”

How does Cathy feel when this happens? Well, Cathy feels unsettled, right? She feels a little strange, a little uncomfortable. Does she feel very, very, very upset? No, she doesn’t. She feels just unsettled, a little upset; and then when she feels unsettled, she says, hesitantly, “Okay. Um, it’s okay.” However, in her head, silently in her head, she is thinking about grammar; and she is reviewing English grammar. Then she feels much better.

When she says okay, does she say it strongly and quickly? No, no, no, she does not. She says it hesitantly. She stops and she starts. She’s not sure. She says, “Uh-uh-uh-uh-uh, oh, okay.” She says it hesitantly, right? When Cathy says okay, she does not say it directly. She says it very, very hesitantly. What does she say hesitantly? Well, she says, “Okay,” hesitantly.

All right. So let’s go back to the top again; and this time, I’m going to pause after key phrases. Please copy my pronunciation. Remember, this is not just repeating words. Repeating words does not help. You need to copy my pronunciation. When I go up, you should go up. When I go down, you should go down. Copy my intonation very carefully. Okay, let’s go to the top. Here we go.

Cathy always obsesses about English. (Pause) Good. Cathy always obsesses about English. (Pause) She constantly worries about taking the TOEFL test. When she worries, she always rubs her hands together. They are always chaffed. (Pause) Good. They are always chaffed. (Pause) Her friend, Gabriel, is the opposite. He always opts to remain relaxed. (Pause) He always opts to remain relaxed. (Pause) Good. He always reprimands Cathy. (Pause) He always reprimands Cathy. (Pause) He says, “Stop obsessing about English, damn it.” (Pause) He says, “Stop obsessing about English, damn it.” (Pause) Good.

Cathy never stands up to Gabriel. (Pause) Cathy never stands up to Gabriel. (Pause) She just says, “I’m sorry. Don’t be mad.” Then she says, “But, um, but let’s go the library now and study English, please.” Gabriel always nixes this idea. (Pause) Gabriel always nixes this idea. (Pause) He says, “Hell, no, we’re not studying English.” Cathy feels unsettled. (Pause) Cathy feels unsettled. (Pause) But she says, hesitantly, “Okay.” (Pause) But she says, hesitantly, “Okay.” (Pause) However, in her head, quietly, she starts to review English grammar. Then she feels much better.

Okay, that is all for this mini-story. Please pause now and try to tell all of the story yourself. Say it out loud, not silently. Say it out loud, speak it out loud. Try to tell all of the story using the new vocabulary and, also, using the correct pronunciation, the correct intonation. If this is difficult, if you cannot do it, no problem. Just listen again. Listen again, listen again. Listening is most important.

Okay, good luck. On to the point of view mini-stories. Bye-bye.

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LEVEL 3

3.1. Cafe Puccini

Publish Date: December 28th, 2006

All Sound (Audio) Archives Available At:
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My favorite **spot** in San Francisco is Cafe Puccini- located in the North Beach neighborhood of the city. North Beach has a long and interesting history. It was originally the neighborhood for Italian **immigrants** in the city- and even today it has many Italian people, cafes, and restaurants. As a kid, the famous baseball player Joe Dimaggio lived in North Beach.

The most famous **period** for the neighborhood, however, was in the late 1950s and the 1960s--when North Beach **served as** the center of San Francisco's **literary renaissance**. **In particular**, North Beach was home to the Beat writers and poets. The Beats **developed** a new, free, open **style** of writing. They also **challenged** the **conservative** society of America in the 50s, and helped create San Francisco's **uniquely liberal** culture. Many **credit** the Beats as the fathers and mothers of the 1960s cultural **renaissance** in America.

Among the most famous Beat writers were Jack Kerouac, Allen Ginsberg, and Gary Snyder- all of whom lived in North Beach at **various** times in their lives. The **focal point** of **the movement** was City Lights Bookstore- owned by the **anarchist** poet Lawrence Ferlinghetti. In the 1950s, City Lights **made history** when they published Allen Ginsberg's **controversial** poem "Howl"- which **shocked mainstream** Americans at the time. Soon after, Jack Kerouac followed with his books "On The Road" and "The Dharma Bums"-- and the Beat movement was born. Ferlinghetti is still the owner of the bookstore, and City Lights is still a popular **independent publisher**.

And North Beach is still home to artists and writers, although it has become much more expensive and now attracts **wealthier residents** as well as tourists. Even though **the literary scene** is not what it used to be- North Beach still has many family owned cafes. You'll find artists, writers, poets, **entrepreneurs**, musicians, businesspeople, and tourists relaxing together in them.

spot: place
immigrants: foreigners who come to live in a (new) country
period: time
served as: was
literary: re: writing and books
renaissance: a time of artistic improvement; a time of art (and science)
in particular: specifically
developed: made, created
style: way of doing something
challenged: disagreed with
conservative: traditional; old; against change
uniquely: specially; not like others
liberal: new; wanting change and improvement; open
credit: compliment; identify
renaissance: a time of great art (and science)
various: different, some
focal point: center point; gathering place
the movement: a change in society; a group trying to change society
anarchist: political group that is against authority and control
made history: became famous; did something famous
controversial: creates conflict or disagreement
shocked: surprised and angered
mainstream: normal (society, culture)
independent publishers: a small bookstore or publisher (not a chain)
wealthier residents: richer people (living in the neighborhood)
the literary scene: the writing situation (in the city)
entrepreneurs: businesspeople who start and own a business

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Effortless English

just: fair, good, correct and fair
by means of: because of
well-disposed: people with good thoughts (with good hearts)
agents: actors, doers
injustice: unfairness, wrongness, badness, evil
undue: too much, not necessary
a file of: a line of
soldiers: fighters, army people
colonel, captain, privates: ranks (levels) of people in the army
admirable: should be admired; worthy, good
against their wills: not by choice; against what they want to do
common sense: what most think is correct and right
conscience: feeling of what is right and wrong; moral feeling
damnable: horrible, terrible, wrong
inclined: what someone usually does or thinks (usually peaceful)
forts: an army building, a base
unscrupulous: without morals; without goodness
the mass of men: most men
the State: the country, the nation
standing army: permanent army
exercise: use (noun)
the judgement: ability to make decisions
the moral sense: ability to decide what is right and wrong
manufactured: made, created
command: demand, require
straw: hay
lump: small round piece
considered: thought to be
abominable: horrible, terrible
obedience: doing what someone else tells you to do
the media: newspaper, TV, etc...
moan: make a sad sound
blame: criticize
shift: move; change
solely: only
carrying out their orders: doing what they say to do
abandoned: left; got rid of
dutifully obeying: doing what other people say-- because of duty

3.2. Disobedience

Publish Date: December 3, 2006

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“Law never made men more **just**; and, **by means of** their respect for it, even the **well-disposed** are daily made the **agents** of **injustice**. A common and natural result of an **undue** respect for law is, that you may see a **file** of **soldiers**, **colonel**, **captain**, **privates** and all, marching in **admirable** order over hills to the wars, **against their wills**, indeed, against their **common sense** and **consciences**. They have no doubt that it is a **damnable** business in which they are concerned; they are all peaceably **inclined**. Now, what are they? Men at all? Or small movable **forts**, at the service of some **unscrupulous** man in power?

The mass of men serve **the State** thus, not as men mainly, but as machines, with their bodies. They are the **standing army**. In most cases there is no free **exercise** whatever of **the judgment** or of **the moral sense**; but they put themselves on a level with wood and earth and stones; and wooden men can perhaps be **manufactured** that will serve the purpose as well. Such people **command** no more respect than men of **straw**, or a **lump** of dirt. They have the same sort of worth only as horses and dogs. Yet such as these are commonly **considered** good citizens.”

-- Henry David Thoreau (Civil Disobedience)

Many of the **abominable** problems in the world are the result of **obedience**. In our personal lives, in **the media**, we cry and **moan** and **blame** "our leaders" for the problems of the world. We **shift** responsibility to them. But are they **solely** responsible? What about the thousands and millions who are actually **carrying out their orders**? These people are the ones actually doing the terrible things that their leaders want done. These people have **abandoned** their conscience and have abandoned their responsibility.

Can such people be considered adult human beings at all; or are they still children, or dogs-- **dutifully obeying** their master-parent?

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3.3. Emotionally Intelligent Husbands

Publish Date: September 16, 2007

Old Audio Article Archives Available At:
http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

by Dr. John Gottman

My **data** on **newlywed** couples **indicate** that more husbands are being **transformed**. About 35 percent of the men we've studied fall into the category of "**emotionally intelligent** husbands". Research from previous decades suggests the number used to be much lower. Because this type of husband **honors** and respects his wife, he will be open to learning more about **emotions** from her. He will come to understand her world and those of his children and friends. He may not **emote** in the same way that his wife does, but he will learn how to better connect with her emotionally. As he does so, he'll make choices that show he honors her. When he's watching the football game and she needs to talk, he'll turn off the TV and listen. He is choosing "us" over "me".

data: n. information, facts
newlywed: adj./n.people who were recently married; newly married
indicate: v. show
transformed:v. changed
emotionally intelligent: adj. good at handling emotions, good at talking about emotions
honors: v. respects
emotions: n. feelings
emote: v. show feelings

I believe the emotionally intelligent husband is the next step in social **evolution**. This doesn't mean that he is **superior** to other men in personality, **upbringing**, or **moral fiber**. He has simply figured out something very important about being married that the others haven't yet. And this is how to honor his wife and **convey** his respect to her. It is really that **elementary**.

evolution: n. change over time, development
superior: adj. better
upbringing: n. how someone was raised (by parents)
moral fiber: n. goodness
convey: v. show, communicate
elementary: adj. simple, basic

The new husband is likely to make his career less of a **priority** than his family life because his definition of success has been **revised**. Unlike husbands before him, he makes a detailed **map of his wife's world**. He **keeps in touch with** his **admiration** and **fondness** for, and he communicates it by turning toward her in his daily actions.

priority: n. something that is important
revised: v./adj. changed, edited
map of his wife's world: detailed knowledge of wife's life
keeps in touch with: remembers
admiration: n. liking, respect
fondness: n. good feelings for

This benefits not only his marriage but his children as well. Research shows that a husband who can accept influence from his wife also tends to be an **outstanding** father. He is familiar with his children's world and knows all about their friends and their fears. Because he is not afraid of emotions, he teaches his children to respect their own feelings-- and themselves. He turns off the football game for them, too, because he wants them to remember him as having had time for them.

outstanding: adj. great

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Effortless English

3.4. First Battle

Publish Date: April 25, 2007

by AJ Hoge

A **howl** from the opposing army..... swords **thudded** against shields... thunder beat **in unison**. Hearts pounded. I gripped my sword... and **braced** the shield against my shoulder. **Giddy tendrils** raced through my gut and chest..... a wild grin broke upon my face. I began to bounce.... knees spring-like.....standing on toes. A racehorse in the gate.

A wild shout went up to my left..... I turned to see a **wiry** warrior **clad in** sparkling **scale** and a green cape..... carrying a coffin shaped shield. He **strode** the front of our lines, turned to our enemies and threw insults against them, "Cowardly vermin of Trimaris, prepare to die"... he shook his sword and our army let out a **cackling** howl. **Goose bumps** spread across arms and belly..... I thudded the **butt** of my (**rattan**) sword on the inside of the shield.... our lines **advanced**.

The enemy continued drumming their shields, and likewise strode forward. Full of **adrenaline**, eyes wide with **awe**, muscles tense as steel..... I approached my first battle... almost forgetting that none of this was "real". No one would die. No one would kill.

This was my introduction to the SCA, or the "Society for Creative **Anachronism**". The SCA is a collection of **oddballs** who dress in **medieval** clothing, **strap on** armor, and beat each other with wooden swords. They also dance, sing, and create works of art. The group is a collection of **outlandish** creatives, **hyper-intelligent geeks**, talented artists, **hammish** performers, history **buffs**, academics, poets, social **misfits**, and folks who simply refuse **to succumb to** the **drudgery** of being "normal". I was a member for nearly ten years.... and loved every minute.

The heart of the SCA is the weekend "event"..... an **affair** that **revolves around** a number of semi-historic activities, usually held at a state park. Typically, a battle or tournament is the **centerpiece** of the "event". My first battle was small by today's standards..... each army had only 100 people. The group now hosts battles which involve thousands of participants... the largest is held annually in Pennsylvania, in August, and is known as the "Pennsics War". As the Pennsics example **implies**, SCA groups and events are spread throughout the United States. In fact, the group is growing internationally, especially in Europe. There are also groups in Japan and Korea.

howl: n. yell, scream
thudded: v. hit, pounded
in unison: adv. at the same time, together, in harmony
braced: v. held
giddy: adj. nervous
tendrils: n. lines, tentacles
wiry: adj. thin with muscles
clad in: v. wearing
scale: n. scale armor
strode: v. walked (confidently)
cackling: v./adj. laughing (loudly)
goose bumps: n. bumps on skin (caused by fear or excitement)
butt: n. bottom
rattan: n. a plant similar to bamboo
advanced: v. moved forward
adrenaline: n. a hormone, a body chemical (released by fear or excitement)
awe: n. amazement
anachronism: n. something out of place in time/history (doesn't belong to that time period)
oddballs: n. strange people
medieval: adj. middle ages period
strap on: v. put on, wear
outlandish: adj. dramatic, fun & creative
hyper-intelligent: adj. very smart
geeks: idiom. smart uncool people
hammish: adj. too dramatic
buffs: n. people who like something, fans
misfits: n. people who don't fit in with normal society
to succumb: v. to be beaten by, to surrender to
drudgery: n. boring work
affair: n. experience, event
revolves around: v. focuses on
centerpiece: n. most important part
implies: v. says indirectly, suggests

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Effortless English

novelist: n. writer, author
critical success: success with critics, good opinion from reviews
considered: v. thought to be
spontaneous: adj. unplanned
confessional: adj. open & honest about one's feelings and life
works: n. books, art projects
roaming: v. moving around, wandering, traveling around
vast: adj. huge, very large and wide
landscape: n. land
sought: v. looked for
find his place: find his purpose
rejecting: v. saying "no" to
desire: n. wish, something you want
structures: rules
experiment with: v. try
to embark: v. go, leave
credited: v. said to be
catalyst: n. start; something that starts (or encourages) an action
counterculture: n. sub-culture, group that rejects the normal culture
profoundly: adj. deeply, seriously
marked by: v. affected by
elder: adj. older
prompted him: v. encouraged him; made him
athletic: adj. re: sports
prowess: n. skill, ability
a star: n. a top performer, top player
achievement: n. success
scholarship: n. money for university
pan out: v. happen, be successful

3.5. Jack Kerouac, King of The Beats

Publish Date: January 12, 2007

Jack Kerouac was an American **novelist**, writer, poet, and artist.

While enjoying popularity but little **critical success** during his own lifetime, Kerouac is now **considered** one of America's most important authors. His **spontaneous**, **confessional prose** style inspired many other writers, including Tom Robbins, Lester Bangs, Hunter S. Thompson, and Bob Dylan.

Kerouac's best known **works** are On the Road, The Dharma Bums, Big Sur and Visions of Cody.

He divided most of his adult life between **roaming** the **vast** American **landscape** and living with his mother. Faced with a changing country, Kerouac **sought** to **find his place**, eventually **rejecting** the conservative values of the 1950s. His writing often reflects a **desire** to break free from society's **structures** and to find meaning in life.

This search led him to **experiment with** drugs and **to embark** on trips around the world. His books are often **credited** as the **catalyst** for the 1960s **counterculture**.

Kerouac was born in Lowell, Massachusetts, to a family of French-Canadians.

Jack didn't start to learn English until the age of six, and at home he and his family spoke French. At an early age, he was **profoundly marked** by the death of his **elder** brother Gérard, an event that later **prompted him** to write the book "Visions of Gerard".

Kerouac's **athletic prowess** led him to become **a star** on his local football team, and this **achievement** earned him **scholarships** to Boston College and Columbia University. At Columbia, he wrote several sports articles for the student newspaper, the Columbia Daily Spectator.

His football scholarship did not **pan out** and he went to live with an old girlfriend, Edie Parker, in New York. It was in New York that

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Effortless English

contributing factor: (partial) cause
life style: way of living (eating, sleeping, etc...)
related: connected; caused by
typified by: including; illustrated by
diabetes: blood sugar disease
obesity: very fat, too much fat
surplus: extra; too much
the other day: a few days ago
calorie: energy unit from food
images: pictures
overweight: fat (adj.)
servings: plates of, dishes of, portion
tasting: very small serving
totaled: was a total of
excess: too much, extra
supposed to: should; probably will
reducing: making smaller
portion: amount you eat, serving
unbelievably: incredibly, amazingly
will: mental strength, mind strength
toxic: poison
avoiding: staying away from
to shift: to change (or move)
mental focus: what you concentrate on; what you think about
foci: plural of “focus” (more than one focus)

3.6. **Lifestyle Diseases**

Publish Date: December 9, 2006

All Sound (Audio) Archives Available At:
http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

by Shiori Iwagaki

The major **contributing factor** to **life style related** diseases, **typified** by **diabetes**, high blood pressure and heart disease, is often **obesity**. Therefore, we have to think about losing **surplus** weight.

When I was watching TV **the other day**, I found a program which tried to introduce a way to cook low-**calorie** dishes. It showed food **images** for a full hour. Then they let 3 **overweight** guests eat 3 full **servings** of curry-rice (Japanese style curry with rice). The dishes were made with lower calories than normal but that “**tasting**” **totaled** 1,800 kcal.

If you have a chance to visit to America, in which many people are struggling to lose **excess** weight, try watching TV. You will find it is filled with food commercials and medicines that are **supposed to** help you lose fat.

However, the best way to lose weight is not by eating low calorie food, but by **reducing** the amount of food you eat.

It is really difficult to reduce your meal **portion** sizes while surrounded by actual food or images of food on TV-- unless you have an **unbelievably** strong **will**. So, it is very important to keep away from this **toxic** food environment. But **avoiding** food advertising images is still not enough. Because if you who want to lose weight, changing your physical environment is not be enough. What is most important is to keep your mental environment free of unhealthy food images.

This is important for all of us. We have to find a way **to shift** our **mental focus** from food to healthier **foci** such as sports, reading or music.

Perhaps instead of calling them “life style related diseases” we should

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3.7. The Role of Media 1

Publish Date: March 28, 2007

by Noam Chomsky

The role of the media in **contemporary** politics forces us to ask what kind of a society we want to live in, and in particular **in what sense** of democracy do we want this to be a democratic society? Let me begin by **counter-posing** two different **conceptions** of democracy.

One conception of democracy **has it** that a democratic society is one in which the public has the means to participate in some meaningful way in the management of their own **affairs** and the **means** of information are open and free. If you **look up** "democracy" in the dictionary you'll get a definition something like that.

An **alternative** conception of democracy is that the public must be **barred from** managing their own affairs and the means of information must be kept **narrowly** and **rigidly** controlled. That may sound like an **odd** conception of democracy, but it's important to understand that it is the **prevailing** conception.

In fact, it has long been, not just **in operation**, but even **in theory**. There's a long history that goes back to the earliest modern democratic revolutions in seventeenth century England which **largely expresses** this **point of view**. I'm just going to **keep to** the modern period and say a few words about how that **notion** of democracy develops, and why and how the problem of media and **disinformation** enters within that **context**.

Learn More:

Noam Chomsky Site
http://www.chomsky.info/

contemporary: adj. modern, current
in what sense: in what manner, in what way or kind
counter-posing: v. comparing
conceptions: n. ideas, theories
has it: v. says
affairs: n. lives, life issues & activities
means: n. methods, ways
look up: v. search for and find, look for and find
alternative: adj. different
barred from: v. prevented from, stopped from
narrowly: adv. in a careful and tight way, in a small way
rigidly: adv. without flexibility, in a strict & tough way
odd: adj. strange
prevailing: adj. common, majority
in operation: in reality, in use, related to how something is done
in theory: in idea, related to idea
largely: adv. mostly
point of view: n. opinion, belief
keep to: v. stay with, stick with
notion: n. idea
disinformation: n. wrong information, lies, propaganda
context: n. situation, environment.

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propaganda: n. government lies
slogan: n. saying, a repeated phrase
pacifistic: adj. peaceful, anti-war
committed to: adj. dedicated to, really wanting
commission: n. group, committee
in turning: v. changing
population: n. society
hysterical: adj. crazy, super-emotional
war-mongering: adj. war-loving, wanting & loving war
tear the Germans limb from limb: idiom. attack & kill them
achievement: n. accomplishment, success
to whip up: v. to create or increase
hysterical: adj. emotional
Red: adj. communist
pretty much: idiom. mostly
unions: n. workers' groups
the media: n. newspapers, (radio, TV, etc...)
establishment: n. most powerful group
enthusiastically: adv. happily, with excitement
progressive: adj. liberal
circle: n. group
took great pride: felt proud
to drive: v. to force, to push
reluctant: adj. hesitant, not really wanting to do something
eliciting: v. bring out, cause
fanaticism: n. crazy & total belief
extensive: adj. thorough, broad
fabrication: n. lying, creating something that is false
atrocities: n. horrible acts, torture & murder...
put it: v. say/said, communicated

3.8. Role of Media 2

Publish Date: April 15, 2007

Early History of Propaganda

by Noam Chomsky

Let's begin with the first modern government **propaganda**. That was by U.S. President Woodrow Wilson's government. Woodrow Wilson was elected President in 1916 on the **slogan** "Peace Without Victory". That was right in the middle of World War I. The population was extremely **pacifistic** and saw no reason to become involved in a European war. Wilson's government was actually **committed to** war and had to do something about it.

They created a government propaganda **commission**, named the Creel Commission, which succeeded within six months **in turning** a pacifistic **population** into a **hysterical**, **war-mongering** population... a population that wanted to destroy everything German, **tear the Germans limb from limb**, go to war, and save the world.

That was a major **achievement**, and it led to a further achievement. Right at that time and after the war, the same techniques were used **to whip up** a **hysterical** Communist (**Red**) Scare-- which succeeded **pretty much** in destroying **unions** and eliminating such dangerous problems as freedom of the press and freedom of political thought. There was very strong support from **the media** and the business **establishment**, which in fact organized much of this. In general, it was a great success.

Among those who participated actively and **enthusiastically** in Wilson's war were the **progressive** intellectuals, a **circle** that **took great pride**, as you can see from their own writings at the time, in having shown that what they called the "more intelligent members of society" (themselves) were able **to drive** a **reluctant** population into a war by terrifying them and **eliciting fanaticism**.

The means used were **extensive**. For example, there was a lot of **fabrication** of **atrocities** by the Germans-- Belgian babies with their arms torn off, all sorts of awful things that you still read in history books. Much of it was invented by the British propaganda ministry whose goal was to (as they **put it**) "direct the thought of most of the world".

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diagram: n. a drawing or graph
linked to: v. connected to
radially: adv. in a circular way, like a circle
generate: v. to create, to make
structure: v. organize
classify: v. to put into groups
image-centered: adj. focused on pictures & images
semantic: adj. related to words & meaning; meaning
portions: n. pieces, parts
presenting: v. showing
radial: adj. circular, like a circle
non-linear: adj. not in a straight line
graphical: adj. with images, with pictures
brainstorming: n. method of creating a lot of ideas in a short time
elements: n. parts
intuitively: adv. instinctively, naturally
concepts: n. ideas
recall: n. memory, remembering
applications: n. uses
revising: n. (gerund) editing
mnemonic: n. something that helps memory
sort out: v. organize, understand
promoted: v. encouraged, advertised
collaborate: v. work together (two or more people work together).
concluded: v. decided
find: v. think, realize
retain: v. keep, remember
rough notes: n. quick notes, unedited notes
sophisticated: adj. complex, complicated

3.9. Mind Maps

Publish Date: January 22, 2007

All Sound (Audio) Archives Available At:
http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

A mind map is a **diagram** used to represent words, ideas, tasks or other items **linked to** and arranged **radially** around a central key word or idea. It is used to **generate**, visualize, **structure** and **classify** ideas, and as an aid in study, organization, problem solving, and decision making.

It is an **image-centered** diagram that represents **semantic** or other connections between **portions** of information. By **presenting** these connections in a **radial**, **non-linear graphical** manner, it encourages a **brainstorming** approach to any given organizational task.

The **elements** are arranged **intuitively** according to the importance of the **concepts** and they are organized into groupings, branches, or areas. The graphic formulation of the information may aid **recall** of existing memories

Mind maps have many **applications** in personal, family, educational, and business situations, including notetaking, brainstorming, summarizing, **revising** and general clarifying of thoughts. For example, one could listen to a lecture and take down notes using mind maps for the most important points or keywords. One can also use mind maps as a **mnemonic** technique or to **sort out** a complicated idea. Mind maps are also **promoted** as a way to **collaborate**.

Software and technique research have **concluded** that managers and students **find** the techniques of mind mapping to be useful, being better able to **retain** information and ideas than by using traditional 'linear' note taking methods.

Mindmaps can be drawn by hand, either as '**rough notes**', for example, during a lecture or meeting, or can be more **sophisticated** in quality. There are also a number of software packages available for producing mind maps.

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3.10. Microsoft's Cyber Censorship

Publish Date: February 2, 2007

All Sound (Audio) Archives Available At:
http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

From **Amnesty** International

In December 2005 Microsoft cooperated with Chinese **authorities** to shut down the **controversial blog** of Zhao Jing (Michael Anti), a Beijing-based researcher for the New York Times, and an active critic of **censorship** in China.

The blog, which was hosted on **servers** located in the United States, was removed and was therefore **censored** not only in China but **globally**. Reacting to **criticism**, Microsoft claims to have **implemented** a new set of standards **to ensure** that they will only remove blogs when they receive formal **legal** notice from the Chinese government and that **access** will only be denied to users in China.

Microsoft's search engine MSN China **filters** the results of searches for **politically sensitive terms**, **displaying** a message in Chinese which states 'Certain content was removed from the results of this search'. Searches undertaken in June 2006 by **AI produced** this message for the words '**Falun Gong**', 'Tibet Independence' and 'June 4' (the date of the Tiananmen Square **massacre**).

Furthermore, Microsoft has **admitted** that it responds to **directions** from the Chinese government by **restricting** users of MSN Spaces from using certain **terms** in their account name, space name, space sub-title or in photo captions. At the same time the company **asserts** that MSN Spaces do not filter blog content in any way. Amnesty International considers this claim to be **at odds with** the facts.

When Microsoft **launched** MSN Spaces in China in June 2005, attempts to create blogs with words including 'democracy', 'human rights' and 'freedom of expression' were **blocked**, producing the following error message (in Chinese): 'You must enter a title for your space. The title must not contain **prohibited** language, such as **profanity**. Please type a different title.' Tests by AI carried out in 2006 demonstrated continued blocking of certain terms

Cyber: adj. related to computers or machines; relating to the internet
Amnesty: n. pardon, forgiveness
authorities: n. government people
controversial: adj. causing argument, at issue
blog: n. web log, internet diary or journal
censorship: n. banning (of information), preventing information from being published
servers: n. big computers that host software, accounts, etc.
censored: v. banned, deleted
globally: adj. world-wide, all over the world.
criticism: n. disapproval
implemented: v. used, done
to ensure: v. to promise, to guarantee
legal: adj. related to the law,
access: n. entry, admission
filters: v. separate, screen
politically sensitive terms: n. words that make the government angry
displaying: v. showing
AI: n. Amnesty International
produced: v. created, made
Falun Gong: n. a spiritual (religious) group- that is often attacked by the Chinese government
massacre: n. killing (of many innocent, peaceful, or weak people)
admitted: v. confessed, agreed
directions: n. orders, commands
restricting: v. limiting, stopping
terms: n. words (or phrases), names
asserts: v. says, insists
at odds with: idiom. does not agree with, goes against
launched: v. started, began
blocked: v. stopped, prevented
prohibited: v. denied, forbidden, banned
profanity: n. bad language, obscenity

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Effortless English

Neo: adj. new
Bedouins: n. an Arabic nomadic tribe
breed: n. kind
flourishing: v. growing and succeeding
roaming: v. moving around
nomadic: adj. always moving, frequently moving
wandered: v. travelled, roamed
come to be known as: v. started to be called
armed with: v. carrying, having
access: n. ability to get & use
muffins: n. kind of cupcake
the world at large: n. the rest of the world
laying off: v. firing
contributing to: adding to
insecurity: n. safety, stability
on the cheap: adv. cheaply
Palo Alto: n. a town in Silicon Valley
declares: v. says
innovation: n. creativity
mobile: adj. able to move
infrastructure: n. public goods and services (ie. roads, phones.)
emerged: v. come out
Kinkos: n. a copy & print shop
Wi-Fi: wireless internet
laptops: n. portable computers
revenge: n. hurting or defeating someone after they hurt you
the means of production: n. the tools for making something
hop: v. jump

3.11. Neo-Bedouins

Publish Date: March 14, 2007

Old Audio Article Archives Available At:
http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

A new **breed** of worker, fueled by caffeine and using the tools of modern technology, is **flourishing** in the coffeehouses of San Francisco. **Roaming** from cafe to cafe and borrowing a name from the **nomadic** Arabs who **wandered** freely in the desert, they've **come to be known as** "bedouins."

San Francisco's modern-day bedouins are typically **armed with** laptops and cell phones, paying for their office space and Internet **access** by buying coffee and **muffins**.

San Francisco's bedouins see themselves changing the nature of the workplace, if not **the world at large**. They see large companies like General Motors **laying off** workers, **contributing to insecurity**. And at the same time, they see the Internet providing the tools to start companies **on the cheap**. In the Bedouin lifestyle, they are free to make their own rules.

"The San Francisco coffeehouse is the new **Palo Alto** garage," **declares** Kevin Burton, 30, who runs his Internet startup “Tailrank” without renting offices. "It's where all the **innovation** is happening."

The move toward **mobile** self employment is also part of what author Daniel Pink identified when he wrote "Free Agent Nation" in 2001.

"A whole **infrastructure** has **emerged** to help people work in this way," Pink said. "Part of it includes places like **Kinkos**, Office Depot and Staples." It also includes places like Starbucks and independent coffee shops, where **Wi-Fi** -- wireless Internet access for **laptops** and other devices -- is available.

"The infrastructure makes it possible for people to work where they want, when they want, how they want," said Pink.

Pink calls it "Karl Marx's **revenge**, where individuals own t**he means of production**. And they can take the means of production and **hop** from coffee shop to coffee shop."

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3.12.New Year's Resolutions

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All Sound (Audio) Archives Available At:
http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

So, have you made your New Year's **resolutions**? What are your goals for the coming year? Do you have **formal**, written resolutions- or just a **vague** plan?

The **tradition** of the New Year's Resolutions goes all the way back to 153 BC. Janus, a **mythical** king of early Rome was placed **at the head of** the calendar.

With two faces, Janus could look back on past events and forward to the future. Janus became the **ancient** symbol for resolutions and many Romans asked for forgiveness from their enemies and also **exchanged** gifts before the beginning of each year.

The New Year has not always begun on January 1, and it doesn't begin on that date everywhere today. It begins on that date only for **cultures** that use a 365-day **solar** calendar. January 1 became the beginning of the New Year in 46 B.C., when **Julius Caesar** developed a calendar that would more **accurately reflect** the **seasons** than previous calendars had.

The Romans named the first month of the year after Janus, the god of beginnings and the **guardian** of doors and entrances. He was always **depicted** with two faces, one on the front of his head and one on the back. Thus he could look backward and forward at the same time. At midnight on December 31, the Romans imagined Janus looking back at the old year and forward to the new. The Romans began a **tradition** of exchanging gifts on New Year's Eve by giving one another branches from **sacred** trees for good **fortune**. Later, nuts or coins **imprinted** with the god Janus became more common New Year's gifts.

A New Year's resolution is a **commitment** that an individual makes to a project or a **habit**, often a lifestyle change that is generally **interpreted** as **advantageous**. The name comes from the fact that these

resolutions: decisions; plans; goals
formal: official; very clear
vague: not clear
tradition: historical action; history; something done for a long time; ritual
mythical: imaginary; religious
at the head of: at the top of; at the beginning of
ancient: very old
exchanged: traded; gave to each other
cultures: countries; societies
solar: sun
Julius Caesar: a famous Roman Emperor (leader)
accurately: correctly; closely
reflect: copy; imitate
seasons: changes of climate and weather: Spring, Summer,....
guardian: protector
depicted: shown
tradition: a habit; a ritual
sacred: holy; religious; special
fortune: luck
imprinted: printed; written; engraved
commitment: strong decision to do something
interpreted: understood as
advantageous: good; helpful; beneficial

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remark: n. comment,
very: adj. exact
debate: n. argument, discussion
provoked: v. caused (a reaction)
incredulity: n. surprise
hangover: n. leftover, effect (usually the leftover effect from drinking too much)
medieval: adj. time period between 600 A.D. to 1500 A.D.
Catholic: adj. The Christian church ruled by the Pope in Rome
era: n. time period (in history)
theist: n. religious person
dogmatic: adj. strong believer (usually in a religion)
atheist: n. person who does not believe there is a "God"
fervently: adv. very strongly
blind faith: n. total belief in something, belief without any doubt
alternatively: adv. on the other hand,
reverse: n. opposite, converse
doctrine: n. philosophical rules
assumes: v. believes, accepts
certitude: n. having no doubt, totally sure
aspect: n. part
clinically: adv. medically, scientifically
standards: n. rules, guidelines
absence: n. lack of
taken to mean: idiom. believed to mean
identical to: adj. equal to
Interpretation: n. understanding, theory, analysis
formulated: v. made, created
model: n. theory
agnosticism: n. idea that nothing is definite or sure
grid: n. table, model, theory
popularize: v. make popular
territory: n. land
restated: v. said again
vividly: adv. clearly, colorfully
dogma: n. strict rules & beliefs
amounts to: equals, is
grandiose: adj. theatrical, too showy
delusion: n. illusion, wrong belief
revised: v. changed
absurd: adj. foolish, crazy
perpetually: adv. constantly, always
astonished: adj. surprised
manage to: v. are able to

3.13. **No Belief**

Publish Date: February 6, 2007

Old Audio Article Archives Available At:
http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

This **remark** was made, in these **very** words, by John Gribbin, physics editor of New Scientist magazine, in a BBC-TV **debate** with Malcolm Muggeridge, and it **provoked incredulity** on the part of most viewers. It seems to be a **hangover** of the **medieval Catholic era** that causes most people, even the educated, to think that everybody must "believe" something or other, that if one is not a **theist**, one must be a **dogmatic atheist**, and if one does not think Capitalism is perfect, one must believe **fervently** in Socialism, and if one does not have **blind faith** in X, one must **alternatively** have blind faith in not-X or the **reverse** of X.

My own opinion is that belief is the death of intelligence. As soon as one believes a **doctrine** of any sort, or **assumes certitude**, one stops thinking about that **aspect** of existence. The more certitude one assumes, the less there is left to think about, and a person sure of everything would never have any need to think about anything and might be considered **clinically** dead under current medical **standards**, where **absence** of brain activity is **taken to mean** that life has ended.

My attitude is **identical to** that of Dr. Gribbin and the majority of physicists today, and is known in physics as "the Copenhagen **Interpretation**," because it was **formulated** in Copenhagen by Dr. Niels Bohr and his co-workers between 1926-28. The Copenhagen Interpretation is sometimes called "**model agnosticism**" and says that any **grid** we use to organize our experience of the world is a **model** of the world and should not be confused with the world itself. Alfred Korzybski tried to **popularize** this outside physics with the slogan, "The map is not the **territory**." Alan Watts, a talented Oriental philosopher, **restated** it more **vividly** as "The menu is not the meal."

Belief in the traditional sense, or certitude, or **dogma**, **amounts to** the **grandiose delusion**, "My current model" -- "contains the whole universe and will never need to be **revised**." In terms of the history of science and knowledge in general, this appears **absurd** and arrogant to me, and I am **perpetually astonished** that so many people still **manage to** live with such a medieval attitude.

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3.14. Storytelling

Publish Date: December 17, 2006

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TPRS (Teaching **Proficiency** through Reading and Storytelling)

"Suppose you want to remember a list of words... you will more **readily** remember the words if you make a sentence or sentences connecting the words in the form of a short story. You would remember it even better if the story was easy to **visualize** and best of all if you could picture a story that was dramatic, or **vulgar**, or **comic**, or in some way involved your emotions.

A story is in fact a good **mnemonic**, and the more **elaborate** the story the better. A story links words to be remembered and it causes you to **build up** scenes that have visual, **aural**, and **sensory associations** for you." (Collin Rose, 1985)

While Effortless English is simple, it is also, in fact, designed according to **research-proven** methods. The major **emphasis** of the Effortless English approach is to help students acquire English **thoroughly** and effectively.

One way to do this is with mini-stories. **At first glance**, the mini-stories may seem **silly**. They are usually kind of foolish and are quite simple. Another thing that may seem strange is that I ask a lot of questions as I **retell** the story. These questions can seem **redundant**, **ridiculously easy**, or **pointless**. But they have a purpose.

The mini-stories are structured to help you more deeply remember the new vocabulary. I use silly or **exaggerated** stories because they are easier to visualize; and visualization **aids** memory. I use short and fairly simple stories because they are also easier to remember and picture. They are also easier for the learner to repeat and retell.

The questions, likewise, have a purpose. First, the questions provide more repetition of the target vocabulary. Repetition is important.

proficiency: ability, skill
readily: quickly and easily
visualize: to picture, to imagine
vulgar: rude; crude
comic: funny
mnemonic: something that helps memory
elaborate: complex, complicated
build up: create; make
aural: sound (re: hearing)
sensory: touch/feel
associations: connections; related thoughts or feelings
research-proven: based on scientific study
emphasis: point or idea; stress
thoroughly: completely
at first glance: initially, in the beginning
silly: not serious; foolish, stupid
retell: tell again, say again
redundant: unnecessarily repeated; repeated too much
ridiculously easy: much too easy
pointless: having no purpose
exaggerated: not realistic; too strong or strange in some way
aids: helps

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3.15. Thriving On Chaos

Publish Date: January 27, 2007

All Sound (Audio) Archives Available At:
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"It is easy to understand why many teachers **revert** to textbooks or worksheets when things around them are in constant, **challenging motion**, but they must learn to be in motion, too. The students are being loud; they are **having a hard time** paying attention to each other; they are having a hard time paying attention to the teacher. We all know that telling students to turn to page 37 and answer the questions can **relieve chaos** and make the room quieter for a time. I've recently heard of a new **trend** of teachers using wireless **microphones** in an effort to keep students' attention and be heard above the other noise in the classroom. Education is not about who can speak the loudest. It's about the students and teacher wanting to listen to each other. A truly **personalized**, small school allows that to happen.

Another reason I look to my friend Tom Peters for ideas on how to deal with the **tough** moments is because he **entitled** one of his books "**Thriving** on Chaos". Tom told me it took him a long time **to land on** that word "thriving". But he was looking for a way of saying you must be ready for and enjoy the process of change. Our schools must be thriving environments, thriving on the chaos and on the beauty. We all need to re-examine our situations from time to time and make sure we are not **sticking to** old patterns in new situations."

--Dennis Littky

I like the phrase "Thriving on Chaos". As we all know, the world is constantly changing and its changing quickly. Science, education, travel, technology, and human relationships are **evolving rapidly**. Sometimes it can feel **overwhelming**.

In fact, many people do become overwhelmed by the **pace** of change. They may become **depressed**. They may **dig in** and become very **conservative** in an effort to stop.... or at least slow the change. Some people even become quite **bitter** about it. Others try **to keep up**, but can't.

Without a doubt, human societies have changed. Its no longer possible to

revert: v. go back to
challenging: adj. difficult
motion: n. movement
having a hard time: idiom. experiencing a difficult situation
relieve: v. cure, make better
chaos: n. constant & unpredictable change
trend: n. something many people are doing, something that is popular
microphones: n. device that increases sound volume
personalized: individualized, made for each person
tough: adj. difficult
entitled: v. named
thriving: v. growing successfully, living and growing in a healthy way
to land on: idiom. to decide to use, to choose (after considering many choices)
sticking to: v. staying with, continuing to do or use
evolving: v. changing with the environment, changing to survive or thrive
rapidly: adv. quickly, fast
overwhelming: adj. too much to handle (too much emotion, too much information. etc.)
pace: n. speed, rate
depressed: adj. very sad
dig in: idiom. to resist change, to fight against change
conservative: adj. doesn't like change or differences
bitter: adj. very angry and frustrated for a long time (ie. months and years)
to keep up: v. to stay equal with, to not fall behind

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dropping like flies: idiom. quitting in large numbers and very quickly
dropout: n. quitting, leaving
less than satisfactory: not good, below average, low quality
proficiency: n. skill, ability
standardized: adj. uniform, fixed
proficient: adj. skilled, good at (doing something)
experience: v. be affected by
That is: in fact, actually
at all costs: idiom. totally, completely, no matter what happens
audio-lingual: n. a teaching method that uses mostly "repeat after me" and substitution drills
grammar analysis: n. a teaching method that focuses mostly on memorizing grammar rules
approaches: n. methods
wide use: n. used a lot, a lot of use
engaging in: v. doing
pattern practice drills: n. repeating the same sentence patterns again and again
theoretically: adv. in idea only, abstractly
infinite: adj. without limit, having no end
TPR: n. Total Physical Response- a teaching method
TPRS: n. Teaching Proficiency through Reading and Storytelling
approximates: v. gets close to, imitates
acquisition: n. getting, learning
receptive: adj. open, receiving

3.16. TPR & Listen First

Publish Date: February 13, 2007

Old Audio Article Archives Available At:
http://www.effortlessenglish.libsyn.com

Foreign language study has not been as successful as it should be. In fact, students are **dropping like flies** from foreign language programs. J.H. Lawson reports that the **dropout** rate in foreign language programs for American high school students is as high as 85% by the third year and 95% by the fourth year.

Another study by John B. Carroll found that students who had studied for two years had a **less than satisfactory proficiency** as measured by **standardized** tests, which means that the first two years did not allow the student to become **proficient** enough to hold a conversation in the language. L.A. Jakobovits also found that most students who study foreign languages will probably never become fluent. Not only will most students have low proficiency in reading, writing, speaking, and listening-- they will actually **experience** negative learning. **That is,** they will learn to avoid the foreign language and culture **at all costs**. This is because of the many frustrations and failures they experience during their foreign language study.

Perhaps the major reason for the lack of success of foreign language programs is the method used. The **audio-lingual** and **grammar-analysis** methods are popular **approaches** that came into **wide use** after World War II. These methods consist of memorizing grammar rules and dialogues and **engaging in pattern practice drills**. These methods do not produce communicative skill because language is "creative" and therefore **theoretically infinite**. Consequently, it is logical to conclude that since language has infinite possibilities, the methods of language instruction should teach the student to communicate creatively. A number of powerful methods have been effective doing just that. These include **TPR**, **TPRS**, Focal Skills, ALG, The Natural Approach, and The Effortless Way.

The first of these, TPR, was created by Dr. James Asher. TPR stands for "Total Physical Response". Learning a language through TPR **approximates** the **acquisition** of your native language. This acquisition follows the order of listening first, and then speaking. Finally, the learner learns to read and write. In the **receptive** listening stage, the child hears different "sounds"

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3.17. Our Universal Journey

Publish Date: December 23, 2006

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A cat with an "**incurable**" kind of cancer. A job that is always **tenuous**. Human relationships that are **fragile**, **unpredictable**, and sometimes **tumultuous**. My own body, seemingly healthy- but still **subject to** disease, **fatigue**, and aging.

Life is unpredictable. However much we think we **have a handle on it,** the truth is we never really know what's to come. Everything can change in an instant. This is a **tough** truth to accept, for though we know **intellectually** that all things in life are **impermanent**, we often don't feel it **instinctively**. We **persist** in our attempts to control life- we imagine that we can predict and **manipulate** future events. We imagine that we control, or at least **have a strong influence on**, external events.

But this is not really **the case**. In fact, all that worry, **manipulation**, and attempted control is mostly wasted energy. We are not the masters of the external world. We cannot predict the future. Our **best laid plans** are always subject to **catastrophic** failure.

There is no **security** to be found in the outside world. There is no secure job, or relationship, or situation of any kind. Everything changes. We can, **conceivably**, lose them all **in the blink of an eye**. Where then is true security to be found? Certainly not in the external world, but rather, internally.

"Trust yourself to react **appropriately** when **catastrophe** happens. **Failure of nerve** is really failure to trust yourself." -- Alan Watts

This is the only true security- the security of trusting yourself, the security of flexibility and **adaptability**, the security of spiritual and emotional **self-reliance**. Rather than **obsess over** external events, we better serve ourselves by obsessing over our inner resources. Our security and happiness come from our inner peace-- our ability to accept any situation, adapt to it, use it, learn from it, and (perhaps)

incurable: cannot be cured
tenuous: uncertain; easy to change
fragile: easy to break, breakable
unpredictable: cannot know the future; unable to know (future)
tumultuous: quickly changing; full of conflict, change, and/or emotion
subject to: possible to be affected by; susceptible to
fatigue: tiredness (longterm)
have a handle on it: control it; are successful with it
tough: difficult
intellectually: mentally; with ideas
impermanent: not permanent, always changing
instinctively: deeply; emotionally; biologically
persist: continue; don't quit
manipulate: control; influence
have a strong influence on: can affect; can change somewhat
the case: the situation
manipulation: attempt to control
best laid plans: best thought plans for the future; best plans
catastrophic: disastrous, terrible
security: safety; changelessness; safe and without change
conceivably: in theory; possibly
in the blink of an eye: suddenly; instantly
appropriately: correctly
catastrophe: disaster; total failure
failure of nerve: fear; worry; failure of courage
adaptability: ability to change with the environment
self-reliance: ability to depend on yourself; ability to help yourself
obsess over: think only about

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Effortless English

3.18. **Validation**

Publish Date: December 16, 2006

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I'm sitting at the table in my apartment, looking out the window. I turn back to the papers **stacked** in front of me. "Interesting", I say, "very interesting".

I **glance over** the test **scores** again-- the **pre-test** numbers, the **post-test** numbers, and the amount each student improved.

"Good, good", I say as I notice that all of the students improved over **the course of** the semester. All the post-test scores are higher than the pre-test scores. Most students improved by a couple of points... but my eyes are **drawn to** two sets of numbers.. two names: Kyoung and Jin. These two students improved **dramatically more** than all of the others. Their post-test scores show **a big jump**.

"What did they do differently?", I ask myself.

At the final class, I ask them. Since all of the students had the same in-class experience, I focus on what they did outside of class. Most students followed **traditional** study methods. They studied textbooks. They used vocabulary books. They went to traditional English (ESL) classes.

But Kyoung and Jin followed a different **approach**. In fact, they actually followed the method I continually **harangued** the class about. They focused on repeated listening and reading for fun. Both students said they **took my advice** seriously and therefore listened to English podcasts and audio articles 1-2 hours every day. Kyoung joined **The Linguist** and **faithfully** uses their system. Both students also read for fun-- mostly "easy" materials such as "National Geographic For Kids", **adolescent novels**, etc.

In TESOL (Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages) **jargon**, these two **exceptional** students followed an "**input**-based approach". **The bulk of** their study time was spent reading and listening to understandable and interesting English materials.

Most students and schools follow an "**analysis**-based approach". The bulk of their time is spent **analyzing** the language, breaking it apart, memorizing grammar "rules", and doing **drills**.

stacked: piled, on top of each other
glance over: look at quickly
scores: results, numbers
pre-test: a test given before a class (or other experience)
post-test: a test given after a class (or other experience)
the course of: the time of; the length of
drawn to: attracted to
dramatically more: much more
a big jump: a large improvement

traditional: usual; normal; old

approach: way of doing something
harangued: tried to convince; tried to persuade; repeatedly talked about something
took my advice: did what I suggested
The Linguist: www.thelinguist.com
faithfully: with belief and confidence
adolescent novels: books for children aged 12-14

jargon: special vocabulary for a specific job or field
exceptional: amazing, great
input: information that comes in (ie. reading and listening)
the bulk of: most of
analysis: carefully looking at the details of something
analyzing: studying the pieces of the language.
drills: repeated practice actions

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stabbing: v. to push a knife into something
kidneys: n. part of body that cleans the blood
unavoidable: adj. can't get away from, can't avoid
scanned: v. to look at quickly
searing: v. burning
flesh: n. skin (& muscle)
numb: adj. without feeling, cannot feel pain
ache: n. a "dull" pain
panic: n. strong fear and confusion
butterflies in my stomach: idiom. nervous, worried
gulped: v. swallowed
sensations: n. (physical) feelings
advisors: n. teachers
flee: v. run away from, run from, avoid
dispassionately: adv. without emotion
delved into: v. go (deeply) into
drained away: v. went away, left slowly
heaved: v. moved suddenly
exhaled: v. breathed out
wash through: v. idiom. go (completely through)
crept: v. came slowly (present tense- to creep)
intense: adj. strong, powerful
vibration: n. shaking
escape: v. get away from
broke through: v. made a big improvement (or change)
Vipassana meditation: n. a kind of mental training
insight: n. understanding
consists of: includes
systematic observation: n. careful & organized looking
variants: n. variations, kinds

3.19. **Vipassana**

Publish Date: Jan 17, 2007

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It felt like two hot knives were **stabbing** me in the back-- right into my **kidneys**. It was a burning pain-- **unavoidable**.

As my mind **scanned** this area of my back, it imagined two white-hot spots **searing** through my **flesh**. My knees also burned. My ankles burned. My feet were **numb** with a dull **ache**. But my back was the worst.

I felt a wave of **panic**-- **butterflies in my stomach** and a tremendous urge to get up and run away. I **gulped**, refocused my mind on the **sensations** in my body, and remained still. I tried to follow the **advisors** instructions-- don't **flee** from the pain, go deeply into it. My mind concentrated on the burning kidneys. I tried to observe the pain **dispassionately**. What was it exactly? What is pain? How, exactly, did it feel? How large was the painful area? How deep?

As I **delved into** the pain, an amazing thing happened-- the panic and fear **drained away**. My body **heaved** suddenly with a long, slow, very deep breath. As I **exhaled**, I felt a deep sense of calm **wash through** me.

A natural, unforced smile **crept** onto my face. My mind remained focused and suddenly the intense pain didn't seem "painful". I noticed that the pain was, in fact, an area of more **intense vibration**--- but I was no longer experiencing it as something to **escape** or avoid.

That was the moment I **broke through**-- at the end of the 8th day of a 10 day **Vipassana meditation** course.

Vipassana is a form of meditation, sometimes translated to English as "**Insight** Meditation". It **consists of** a deep and **systematic observation** of one's mind and body. Vipassana has many **variants** and is taught by many different meditation schools, teachers, and groups.

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Effortless English

3.20.**Worthy Goals**

Podcast Date: November 25, 2006

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There I was, **trapped** in a tiny office, **staring** at the clock. Time seemed to go **at a glacial pace**. I turned back to the computer, put my hands on the keyboard, and stared at the **screen**. I sat like that for hours- doing no work. But if someone walked by my office, it looked like I was working on the computer.

Day after day, I did the same **mind numbing routine**. It was the most **miserable** job I ever had-- working for IBM.

Is it possible to make a living in an honest, **inspiring**, interesting way? Is it possible to have freedom and **autonomy** in one's work life? Does work have to be boring and **degrading**?

Last night I watched the movie "Office Space", a **comedy** about office workers. It was very funny because it was so true. As I watched, I remembered my experiences working for IBM- many years ago. The movie **captured** the **sterility**, the **numbness**, and the **pointlessness** perfectly.

Sadly, most jobs are like this. Most jobs, in my opinion, are factories of **degradation**. The workers' spirit and soul are **crushed**. Over time, people who work in such jobs become empty- depressed, **heartless**, and boring. Hakim Bey once wrote that "work is the most **oppressive** force we **face**, the greatest source of **misery** in our lives." This has certainly been true for me. I hated my job at IBM. I hated the sterility. I hated the **insincerity**. I hated the **drab** offices. I hated the boredom and **humiliation**.

Since then, I've been on **a quest** for a better **livelihood**. I've been searching and **searching fo**r a good job- for something I love to do. I found that in teaching English. I love doing it. I love working with the students. They excite and **inspire** me. I love my time in the classroom.

trapped: stuck; cannot escape; cannot leave
staring: looking at something a long time
at a glacial pace: very very slow
screen: monitor

mind numbing: very boring
routine: an action you do many times; a habit
miserable: very unhappy; very painful and terrible
inspiring: makes you feel excited; makes you want to be better
autonomy: self-reliance; personal freedom and power
degrading: makes you feel weak
comedy: a funny movie
captured: caught; showed
sterility: without beauty, life, or emotion
numbness: no feeling; cannot feel
pointlessness: without a purpose
degradation: weak and powerless feeling
crushed: destroyed; broken into many tiny pieces; pressed until broken
heartless: having no kindness or emotion
oppressive: controlling; something that controls you and makes you weak
face (verb): encounter; meet
misery: pain, sadness, suffering
insincerity: without honesty; dishonesty
drab: ugly; without color
humiliation: embarrassment
quest: a search for something
livelihood: way of making money; way of working
searching for: looking for; trying to find
inspire: create feelings of excitement; make someone want to be a better person.

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LEVEL 4

4.1. Hitch Intro

Publish Date: February 14, 2007

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Basic principles:
No woman wakes up saying: "God, I hope I don't get **swept off my feet** today."

Now, she might say, "This is a really bad time for me."
Or something like, "I just **need some space**." Or my personal favorite: "I'm really **into my career** right now."

You believe that? Neither does she. You know why? Because she's lying to you, that's why. You understand me? Lying.
It's not a bad time for her. She doesn't need any space.
She may be into her career... but what she's really saying is, "Get away from me now." Or possibly, "Try harder, stupid." Well, which one is it?

60 % of all human communication is **nonverbal**-- Body language.
30% is your **tone**. So that means that 90% of what you're saying... **ain't** coming out of your mouth.

(Toby! Shit!)

Of course she's gonna lie to you. She's a nice person; she doesn't **wanna hurt your feelings**. What else is she gonna say? She doesn't even know you. Yet.
Luckily, the fact is, that just like the rest of us... even a beautiful woman doesn't know what she wants-- until she sees it.

And **that's where I come in**.
My job is to **open her eyes**.
(Toby! Oh, my God! Is this what you're looking for?)

Basic principles: No matter what, no matter when, no matter who..
any man has a chance to **sweep any woman off her feet**.
Just **needs the right broom**.

swept off my feet: idiom. fall in love very strongly

need some space: idiom. need time alone, need time away from other people

into my career: idiom. focused on my job, concentrating on my job

nonverbal: adj. not speech, not related to speaking
tone: n. intonation, pitch
ain't: v. (casual) am not, are not, is not
wanna: v. want to
hurt your feelings: idiom. make you feel upset or sad or hurt

that's where I come in: idiom. that's when I begin, that's where I start

open her eyes: idiom. make her understand, make her realize

sweep any woman off her feet: idiom. make any woman fall in love with (him, you)
needs the right broom: joke. needs the right technique (he's joking about the different meanings of the word "sweep" here).

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4.2. **Hitch 1**

swept off my feet: idiom. fall in love very strongly

need some space: idiom. need time alone, need time away from other people

into my career: idiom. focused on my job, concentrating on my job

nonverbal: adj. not speech, not related to speaking

tone: n. intonation, pitch

ain't: v. (casual) am not, are not, is not

wanna: v. want to

hurt your feelings: idiom. make you feel upset or sad or hurt

that's where I come in: idiom. that's when I begin, that's where I start

open her eyes: idiom. make her understand, make her realize

sweep any woman off her feet: idiom. make any woman fall in love with (him, you)

needs the right broom: joke. needs the right technique (he's joking about the different meanings of the word "sweep" here).

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Well, which one is it?

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Of course she's gonna lie to you. She's a nice person; she doesn't wanna hurt your feelings. What else is she gonna say? She doesn't even know you. Yet.
Luckily, the fact is, that just like the rest of us... even a beautiful woman doesn't know what she wants-- until she sees it.

And that's where I come in.
My job is to open her eyes.
(Toby! Oh, my God! Is this what you're looking for?)

Basic principles: No matter what, no matter when, no matter who..

any man has a chance to sweep any woman off her feet.
Just needs the right broom.

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4.3. Hitch 2

Publish Date: February 25, 2007

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You cannot use what you do not have. So if you're shy, be shy.
If you're **outgoing**, be outgoing.

- I'm not outgoing.
- That's okay.

She may not want the whole truth, but she does want the real you.
She may not want to see it **all at once**, but she does want to see it.

So tonight, when you're wondering what to say, how you look, or if she likes you... just remember, she is already out with you.
That means she said yes when she could have said no.
That means she made a plan when she could have just **blown you off**.
So that means it is no longer your job to try to make her like you.
It is your job not to **mess it up**.

The shoes are **hot**.
You went to the place I told you?
Yeah, but I don't think **they're really me**.
"You" is a very **fluid concept** right now.
You bought the shoes. You look great in the shoes.
That's the you I'm talking about.

The key tonight is **hang back**. Give her plenty of space.
If she **lingers** at a photograph, move on. But **maintain the visual**.
It's supposed to be 64 and clear tonight.
So when you leave the club, walk a little.
Ask her what she thought about the show...
what was her favorite photograph,
why that one.
And when she answers, don't be looking at her mouth.
Don't be wondering what she looks like **naked**.
Listen to what she is saying and respond.
Listen and respond.

outgoing: adj. friendly & sociable, (opposite of shy)

all at once: idiom. suddenly; everything done very quickly

blown you off: idiom. to reject someone; to skip an appointment with someone (similar to "to stand you up")
mess it up: idiom. ruin it, cause a big problem, make a big mistake
hot: adj./idiom. great (look great)
they're (really) me: idiom. they fit my personality, they fit my usual style
fluid: adj. easily changed, very flexible
concept: n. idea
hang back: idiom. stay back, don't get too close
lingers: v. stays at, remain in one place for a while
maintain the visual: idiom. keep eye contact, stay in eye contact

naked: adj. without clothes

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Effortless English

4.3. **Hitch 3**

call it: v. predict it

screw: v. have sex with
going out with: idiom. dating
awesome: adj. fantastic, great

fabulous: adj. amazing

run: v. print, publish
aristo-: n. aristocrat (rich person)
-brat: n. a spoiled person
gorgeous: adj. beautiful

cheat: v. be unfaithful, have sex with someone who is not your spouse/partner

Bitter: adj. lonely and angry (he's joking about her)
party of one: idiom. group of one (used when entering a restaurant)
Barbados: n. a tropical island

just what the doctor ordered: idiom. exactly what I needed
flirted: v. tease, try to attract someone (who you want to date)
never left the office: idiom. never stopped working

Did I **call it** or did I call it? I mean, what did I say, six months?
And when was her first date?

So five-and-a-half?

God, I hate it when I'm right.
What is it about guys that makes them want to **screw** anything that walks...
even when they're **going out with** someone as **awesome** as Allegra Cole?

She's only the most **fabulous** thing walking around New York.

Thanks, Young.

Are you kidding?Of course I'm gonna **run** it.
Why should she waste her heart on some Swedish **aristo-brat**?
Even if he is **gorgeous**.

If he's stupid enough to **cheat**...
the world should know he's dumb enough to get caught.

Exactly. I'm in the elevator.
See you in a minute.
Good morning, how are you?
Bitter, **party of one**.
You should try it sometime.
Barbados by myself? I wouldn't last five minutes.

It was **just what the doctor ordered**.
I slept in, I did my yoga,
I read a couple of books... **flirted** with my scuba instructor.

- And apparently **never left the office**.
- I know, isn't that great?
You should've taken someone with you.
Who am I gonna take with me?

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comes in handy: idiom. is useful

This is where a boyfriend **comes in handy**.
- I don't have time for a boyfriend.
- You said that two years ago.

-Yes, and it's as true today as it was then.
-I thought you were on vacation.
-See if these are in focus and have them in my desk in an hour.
Besides, relationships are for people waiting for something better to come along.

Spoken like a true **cynic**.

cynic: n. a negative & pessimistic person

I'm not a cynic. I'm a **realist**.

realist: n. a person who is realistic, a person who is very practical

You are a realist **masquerading as** a cynic who is secretly an optimist.

masquerading as: v. pretending to be

What are you doing here?
What is she doing here?

She works here, remember?
No, she doesn't. Not for another four days.
This couldn't wait.
It could.

workaholic: n. someone who works too much (addicted to work)

What are you doing? Go back to the beach.I don't want you here.
No, really, you do.

lunatic: n. crazy person

You are becoming a sick, **workaholic lunatic**... and this is exactly...

overwrought: adj. too nervous, too energetic

the kind of nervous, **overwrought** behavior that leads to...

Sebby: n. name of the rich Swedish guy (in the movie)

Pictures of **Sebby** with a **busty** brunette.
...A very big raise.

busty: adj. having large breasts

Jesus. You could find **dirt** in a snowstorm.
Comes with the job.
You know, kiddo, there is more to life than watching other people live it.

dirt: idiom. gossip

Can I help he was cheating on my beach?
I think it's great that you're so good at your job.
I'm just a little worried as to why.
Let me worry about that.
Okay. I want that **column** on my desk by lunch.

column: newspaper article (that appears regularly)

So you'll pay for my hotel?

sip: v. to drink slowly

For you to **sip mai tais**? I don't think so. Get out.

mai tais: n. a cocktail, a kind of alcoholic drink

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Effortless English

The Key To Excellent Speaking

What is the most important English skill? What skill must you have to communicate well?

Obviously, number 1 is Fluency. What is fluency? Fluency is the ability to speak (and understand) English quickly and easily... **WITHOUT translation**. Fluency means you can talk easily with native speakers-- they easily understand you, and you easily understand them. In fact, you speak and understand **instantly**.

Fluency is your most important English goal.

The research is clear-- there is only **ONE** way to get fluency. You do not get fluency by reading text-books. You do not get fluency by going to English schools. You do not get fluency by studying grammar rules.

Listening Is The Key

To get English fluency, you must have a lot of understandable repetitive **listening**. That is the ONLY way. To be a FANTASTIC English speaker, you must learn English **with your ears**, not with your eyes. In other words, you must listen. Your ears are the key to excellent speaking.

What kind of listening is best? Well, it must be understandable and must be repetitive. Both of those words are important-- **Understandable** and **Repetitive**.

If you don't understand, you learn nothing. You will not improve. That's why listening to English TV does not help you. You don't understand most of it. It is too difficult. It is too fast.

Its obvious right? If you do not understand, you will not improve. So, the best listening material is EASY. That's right, you should listen mostly to **easy English**. Most students listen to English that is much too difficult. They don't understand enough, and so they learn slowly. Listen to easier English, and your speaking will **improve faster**!

Understanding is Only Half The Formula.

Understanding is not enough. You must also have a lot of **repetition**. If you hear a new word only once, you will soon forget it. If you hear it 5 times, you will still probably forget it!

You must hear new words and new grammar **many times** before you will understand them **instantly**.

How many times is necessary? Most people must hear a new word **30** times to remember it forever. To know a word and instantly understand it, you probably need to hear it 50-100 times!

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Effortless English

Learning Languages Like Children

By Dr. J. Marvin Brown

In 1984, the American University Language Center in Bangkok started using **a new approach** to teach the Thai language. The method is called '**The Listening Approach**'. In more recent years it's become known as 'Automatic Language Growth'.

The method says that any **attempt to speak** (or even think about language), before automatic speaking comes, **will cause damage** and limit final results! In other words, the method uses a **very long "silent period"**.

During the "silent period", students **focus only on listening**. After 6 - 12 months of intensive listening, students begin to speak spontaneously and naturally-- without effort and without thinking!

ONE - THE CHILD'S SECRET

Everyone knows that when people move to a new country the **children** will eventually **speak the language natively** and the **adults won't**. The normal explanation is that children have a special 'talent' that they lose as they grow up.

Teachers said that **for adults**, languages should be **taught and studied** instead of learned naturally.

But are we any better with present language teaching? Why, for example, do adults in Central Africa do better when they move to a new language community than our modern students do? Could it be that early **teachers were mistaken**? Maybe **adults can** do what children do. Maybe it's just adult behavior (not lack of talent) that prevents them from succeeding.

THE MISTAKE – Children can do something that adults cannot.

THE UNASKED QUESTION – What would happen if an adult were to just listen for a year without speaking?

OUR ANSWER – **Both** adults and children **can do it right**, but only adults can do it wrong.

Imagine a 4 year-old child and an adult reacting to somebody talking to them in a foreign language. **The child most often just listens**, while the adult usually tries to talk back.

Now imagine that **'not trying to speak' was the child's secret**. It makes sense that listening to things that are always right would build the language right, while saying things that are always wrong would build it wrong.

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Rule1. Study Phrases, Not Individual Words

Hi. How are you doing today? I'm writing because you asked for my 7-Day email course and you want to improve your English. You will get 8 emails from me-- one every day for 8 days.

This Email Course is sent only to subscribers.
To unsubscribe, go to {!remove_web}

My name is A.J. Hoge. I live in San Francisco, USA. I am an English teacher. I have a Masters degree in Teaching English. I enjoy travel, SCUBA diving, motorcycle riding, movies, and learning Spanish.

I will teach you a new method for learning. I will teach you how to study-- to speak English faster and more easily.

***Your First Suggestion**

Imagine speaking English automatically... without thinking. The words come out of your mouth easily, and fast. You understand instantly.

To do this, you must change the way you study English. Your first action is to stop studying English words. What?

Stop studying English words.

That's right, do not memorize words. Native speakers do not learn English by remembering single words. Native speakers learn phrases.

Phrases are GROUPS of words that naturally go together.

****Learn 4x Faster**

Research by Dr. James Asher proves that learning with phrases is 4-5 times faster than studying individual words. 4-5 Times Faster.

Also, students who learn phrases have much better grammar.

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RULE 2: Don't Study Grammar

Hi. How are you? Are you having a good day? I'm doing fine. Let's get started with Day 2 of your email course.

Rule 2: A Story From Angelina

"My name is Angelina and I'm a student from Paraguay. When I started learning with A.J., I couldn't speak any English. I had studied English grammar many years, but I couldn't speak.

The first day with A.J.'s Effortless English I thought I would study grammar. However, he surprised me because he never taught grammar rules.

Instead, he told a story. He told it many times, in a strange way. He constantly asked questions, and I answered the questions. The questions were super-easy.

Honestly, I was a little confused. I thought he was kind of a crazy teacher :) I thought I needed to learn more grammar.

I continued with Effortless English and then, after only two weeks, something amazing happened. My speaking improved! My friends asked me, 'How are you improving so quickly?'

I realized that A.J. was quite clever, and the stories and questions and articles were teaching me to speak English, without studying grammar rules. Wow!"

Angelina is a great student. She learned extra fast because she listened to Effortless English 5 hours a day. However, you can improve with just one hour a day.

You can get the same results... but you must follow Rule 2.

RULE 2: Don't Study Grammar

Angelina quickly improved speaking-- when she stopped studying grammar. This is your second rule.

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RULE 3: The Most Important Rule: Listen First

Hi! This is A.J. again, with the next day of your 7 Rules Email Course. I really enjoy emailing you and helping you improve English.

Today is the most important rule.

Most schools ignore it.

****Rule 3: A Story**

Humberto is from Venezuela. He moved to Canada a few years ago. He studied English in Venezuela for many years-- mostly grammar.

In fact, Humberto learned English with his eyes- by reading textbooks, by studying grammar books, by remembering word lists.

He thought his English was good. But when he came to Canada he was surprised and shocked-- he couldn't understand anyone!
He joined an English school in Canada. He went to school everyday. What did they teach him? More textbooks, more grammar books, more word lists!

After 12 months of school, Humberto was angry and frustrated. The school cost over $10,000 for one year-- but he still could not speak English. He didn't know what to do.

He said:

"I couldn't believe it A.J. After one year, I still couldn't speak English. I told the teacher, 'this is a waste of time'. I was very upset.

Thank God I found a better way. Now I can speak English. I understand native speakers. I talk to Canadians every day. I feel confident. I can't believe I wasted so much time with schools... and so much money too!"

****RULE 3: The Most Important Rule-- Listen First**

What is the rule that Humberto found? Simple. The rule is listening.

Listening, listening, listening.

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RULE 4: Slow, Deep English Learning Is Best

Hi. Its me again ;) I hope you are feeling good and are enjoying the 7 Rules Email Course. Here's rule 4.

****Rule 4: A Story**

Hyun, a student from Korea, said:

"Im a very serious student. When studying English in Korea, I memorized 50,000 English words for a big test. Fifty Thousand!

My problem was-- I couldn't USE them. I could pass an English test. But I could not understand native speakers.

With Effortless English, I learned to instantly understand English. I learned how to automatically use vocabulary. After 6 months, I could speak easily. I didn't need to think.

Thanks so much!"

****RULE 4: Slow, Deep Learning Is Best**

Hyun learned a lot of words in a short time. Her learning was short and shallow. That's why she quickly forgot the words. That's why she could not use them.

The secret to speaking easily is to learn every word & phrase DEEPLY.

Its not enough to know a definition. Its not enough to remember for a test. You must put the word deep into your brain.

To speak English easily, you must repeat each lesson many times.

You must learn English deeply.

> Learn deeply, speak easily.
> Learn deeply, speak easily.

How do you learn deeply? Easy-- just repeat all lessons or listening many times. For example, if you have an audio book, listen to the first chapter 30 times before you go to the second chapter. You could listen

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RULE 5: Use Point Of View Mini-Stories

Hi. How are you today? Are you having a great day? I'm doing well.

Today I'm back to explain Rule 5. I hope you are enjoying these emails :)

On Day 2, I told you never to study grammar rules. But, of course, you want to use correct English grammar.

Maybe you are thinking, "How can I learn English grammar if I don't study English grammar rules?"

Well, today I will tell you.

I will teach you a way to learn grammar naturally. Use this method and your grammar will improve automatically. You will automatically use the correct verb tense. You won't think. You won't try.

****Rule 5: A Story**

Miyuki did very well on grammar tests. She knew all of the grammar rules. She knew English verbs.

But Miyuki had a problem. She couldn't USE the grammar in a real conversation. She could explain the past tense, but when speaking, she would say "Yesterday I GO to school".

Miyuki was confused. How could her grammar tests be so good, but her speaking so bad?

Miyuki said:

"Before Effortless English, I knew all the grammar rules, but I couldn't speak correctly. I couldn't feel English grammar. After using Point of View stories, I feel it and use it correctly.

Now my grammar is great when I speak. I never think about it, I just automatically use correct grammar. Thank you A.J.!"

> Miyuki learned this grammar naturally. She never studied grammar rules. How did she do it?

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RULE 6: Only Use Real English Lessons & Materials

Hi again :) It's me, your English teacher... with another rule!

I want you to think about something today: You have studied English for more than 4 years- why do you still have trouble understanding native speakers?

Nothing is wrong with you. Something is wrong with the schools you went to, and the textbooks you used. English textbooks and audio tapes are horrible.

You never learned REAL English.

You learned TEXTBOOK English.

****How To Understand Native Speakers**

Megdelio studied English for 5 years in Venezuela. Teachers said he was an advanced student.

When he came to the USA he felt good. He was excited to meet Americans. He was ready. He wrote:

"One day I tried to talk to an American woman and everything changed. The woman started talking-- and I couldn't understand her. Not at all!

Her pronunciation was totally different than the textbook tapes and CDs I listened to. She used idioms, slang, and many casual phrases.

I was totally confused. That's when I realized I needed to learn real English!"

****You Must Learn Real English**

I taught Megdelio to learn with real English materials-- learning the English we use everyday in conversations, books, movies, TV shows, comic books, audio books, articles, newspapers, magazines, and podcasts.

****Stop Learning Textbook English**

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RULE 7: Listen and Answer, not Listen and Repeat

Hi. Today is the last rule! Remember, I promised to send you 8 emails. Today is number 7 :)

Today is the last Rule, and it is the easiest:

Most English CDs use "listen and repeat". The speaker says something in English, and you repeat exactly what they said. This method is a failure.

****Rule 7: A Story**

Emi, a Japanese woman, had a problem. Her speaking was SLOW. She could not answer questions quickly.

Emi listened to many English tapes and CDs. She listened. She repeated what the speaker said.

Emi emailed me. I recommended "Listen & Answer" lessons. I told her not to use "listen and repeat".

I told her to use "Listen & Answer" Mini-Stories.

I told her that "listen and repeat" is not enough-- when you repeat, you only copy the speaker. But when you hear a question and you ANSWER it-- you must think in English.

After using listen & ANSWER lessons for just 4 months, her speaking was fast, easy, and automatic.

Emi was excited. She wrote:

"The lessons are FANTASTIC! I love them. My speaking is so much faster now. I understand quickly and I can now speak English without thinking. I can't believe it!"

****RULE 7: Listen and Answer, not Listen and Repeat**

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Effortless English



English Trauma

There I was, in an English class, in Japan. The Japanese teacher was standing in front of a class of middle school students. The students were young and eager. I sat to the side, watching.

The teacher wrote an English sentence on the blackboard: "John is taller than Mary".
Then she began to talk in Japanese. As she talked, she circled different words of the sentence. She circled the word "John" with blue chalk. She talked, and talked, and talked.... in Japanese... as she pointed to the word "John".

The students opened their notebooks and began writing. The teacher also began writing more on the board- in Japanese. Long sentences in Japanese. Then she pointed to the word "John" again.

I couldn't understand Japanese and I wondered, "What is she talking about? How can she talk so much about just one word-- its just a name."

Finally, the teacher circled the word "Mary". Then she started talking again, in Japanese. She pointed to the word. She wrote long notes in Japanese. The students wrote, and wrote, and wrote in their notebooks. They looked serious and a little confused. The teacher continued talking-- always in Japanese.

Finally, after almost 10 minutes, she finished explaining the word "Mary" (in Japanese). The students were now looking stressed and tired.

The teacher underlined the word "is" next, using white chalk. Then she did it again--- talking, talking, talking, talking, talking, and talking in Japanese. Writing, writing, writing, and writing... in Japanese.

This continued for the entire class. She eventually circled "taller" and "than" with green chalk, and talked for over 20 minutes about these two words. By the end of the class, the young students were tired, stressed, and totally confused.

In 50 minutes, they had heard only one sentence in English, repeated only one time. In that same time, they had heard the teacher speak Japanese for nearly 49 minutes.